Mahakumbh
2025
THE WORLD'S LARGEST
SPIRITUAL GATHERING
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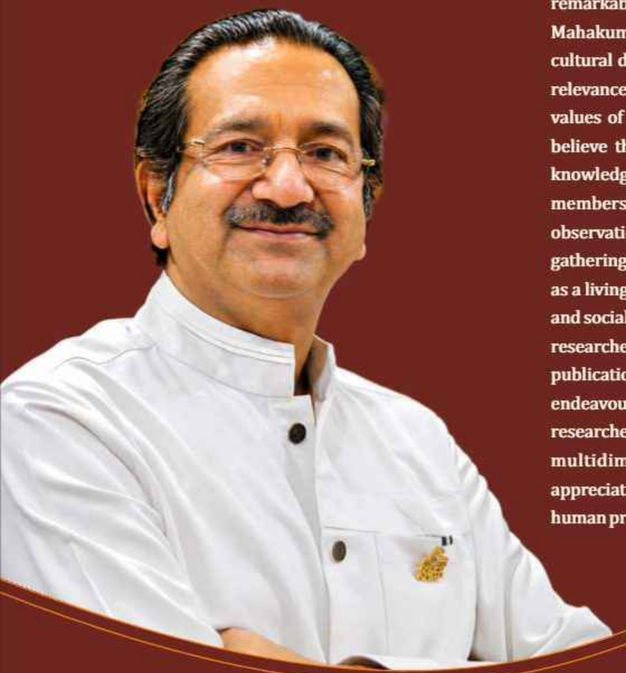
॥ महाकुंभ ॥

आस्था, अध्यात्म और संस्कृति का महासंगम



MESSAGE

It is a matter of immense pride and privilege to share my thoughts in this commemorative volume dedicated to Mahakumbh 2025, one of the most remarkable expressions of India's spiritual heritage and civilizational legacy. Mahakumbh 2025 exemplified the harmonious convergence of spirituality, cultural diversity, social unity, and timeless wisdom. It reaffirmed the enduring relevance of our ancient traditions while inspiring contemporary society with values of faith, discipline, and collective responsibility. At SAGE University, we believe that true education extends beyond classrooms, combining academic knowledge with experiential learning. Guided by this philosophy, our faculty members and students actively participated in Mahakumbh 2025 through observation, documentation, and scholarly reflection, transforming this historic gathering into a unique learning experience. This volume presents Mahakumbh as a living university of humanity, where faith, culture, knowledge, management, and social consciousness intersect. It reflects the collective efforts of our scholars, researchers, students, editors, and contributors, whose dedication has made this publication possible. I extend my sincere appreciation to everyone involved in this endeavour. I am confident that this book will serve as a valuable resource for researchers, students, policymakers, and readers seeking to understand the multidimensional significance of Mahakumbh. May it inspire a deeper appreciation of the timeless dialogue between faith, knowledge, tradition, and human progress.

Er. Sanjeev Agrawal

Chairman & Managing Director
SAGE Group

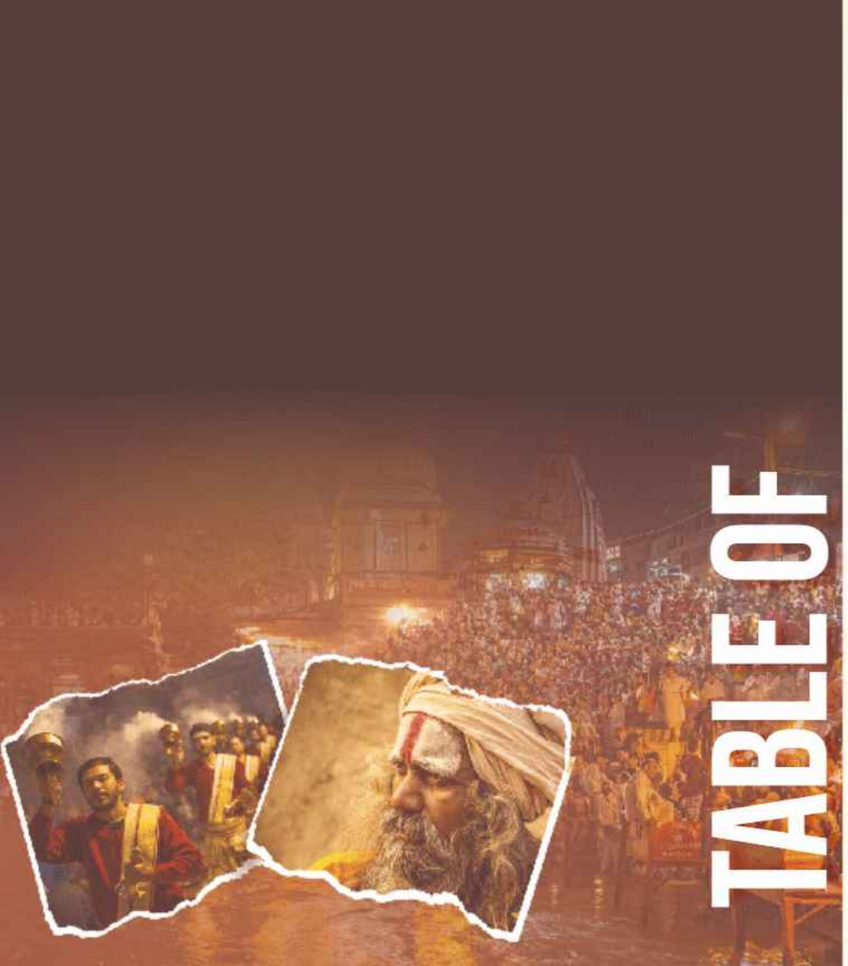
PREFACE

Human civilisation has advanced through a continuous pursuit of knowledge, understanding, and harmony. Among all living beings, humans possess the unique ability to reason, innovate, and reflect. The sages and seers of ancient India were not only spiritual guides but also philosophers, educators, and keen observers of nature whose teachings integrated intellectual inquiry with spiritual wisdom, shaping India's enduring cultural heritage. The Mahakumbh is one of the finest expressions of this heritage. More than a religious congregation, it represents India's civilizational continuity, cultural diversity, social harmony, and collective consciousness. Recognising the educational and cultural importance of Mahakumbh 2025, SAGE University encouraged its faculty and students to experience this historic event firsthand. Through field visits, they observed, documented, and studied its diverse spiritual, cultural, social, and organisational dimensions.

This book is the outcome of those collective efforts. It presents a thoughtful exploration of Mahakumbh 2025, highlighting its spiritual significance, cultural richness, societal impact, and exemplary management. We hope this volume will serve as a valuable resource for scholars, students, researchers, policymakers, and all readers seeking to understand Mahakumbh as a remarkable civilizational phenomenon. May these pages inspire a deeper appreciation of the timeless confluence of faith, knowledge, culture, and human aspiration that Mahakumbh continues to embody.

Ar. Shivani Agrawal

Editors-In-Chief, Managing Director,
SAGE Group



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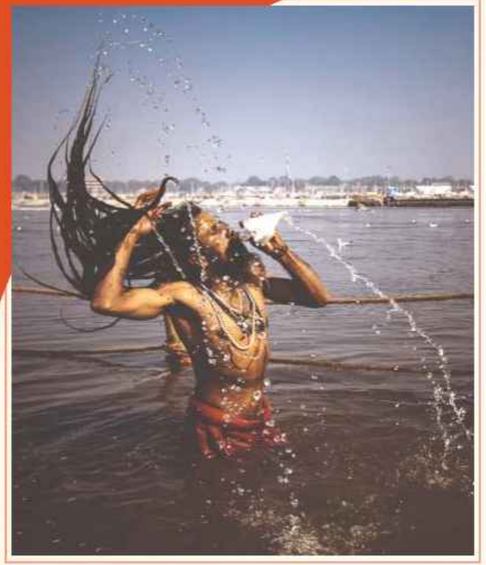
INTRODUCTION
AN OVERVIEW

MAHA KUMBH 2025:
A GRAND TAPESTRY OF SPIRITUALITY AND CULTURE

Introduction

In the realm of Hinduism, there exists a sacred congregation of unparalleled majesty, the Maha Kumbh Mela, which unfolds once every twelve years. This grand spectacle, witnessed by millions, is a testament to the enduring power of faith and the indomitable human spirit. In the year 2025, the city of Prayagraj, situated in the state of Uttar Pradesh, hosted this magnificent event, as millions of devotees converged upon the sacred Triveni Sangam to participate in this auspicious occasion. The Maha Kumbh Mela is an event of immense spiritual significance, where millions of pilgrims gather to cleanse themselves spiritually by taking a ritual bath at the Triveni Sangam, one of the most sacred sites in Hinduism, where the Ganga, the Yamuna, and the Saraswati rivers meet.

The Maha Kumbh Mela (the festival of the sacred pitcher) is anchored in Hindu mythology. It is the world's largest public gathering and collective act of faith. This congregation primarily includes Ascetics, Saints, Sadhus, Sadhvis, Kalpvasis and Pilgrims from all walks of life. The Maha Kumbh Mela is a grand assembly of rituals, with the bathing ceremony being the most significant of them. It is firmly rooted in the belief that by immersing oneself in the holy waters, one can cleanse oneself of all sins, liberate both oneself and one's ancestors from the cycle of rebirth, and ultimately attain Moksha, or spiritual liberation. In addition to the bathing ritual, pilgrims also engage in worship on the banks of the sacred river and actively participate in enlightening discourses led by various sadhus and saints.



While it is considered sacred to take a dip in the holy waters throughout the Prayagraj Maha Kumbh, beginning from the auspicious occasion of Paush Purnima, there are specific dates that hold special significance. These dates witness magnificent processions featuring saints, their disciples, and members of various Akharas (religious orders). They partake in the grand ritual known as Shahi Snan, also referred to as 'Raj yogi Snan', marking the commencement of the Maha Kumbh Mela. Raj yogi Snan stands as the central highlight of the Kumbh Mela and represents the pinnacle of the celebration.

The important dates in the 2025 Mela were:

- Paush Purnima : 13 January 2025
- Makar Sankranti : 14 January 2025
- Mauni Amavasya : 29 January 2025
- Basant Panchami : 03 February 2025
- Maghi Purnima : 12 February 2025
- Maha Shivaratri : 26 February 2025

Maha Kumbh, 2025, was a sacred pilgrimage and celebration of faith that drew millions of devotees and travellers from all corners of the globe. As one embarked on this extraordinary journey, they discovered many attractions that made the Maha Kumbh a truly unique and awe-inspiring event. The UP Government, in collaboration with MyGov, hosted citizen engagement activities to celebrate the grand legacy of Maha Kumbh, a symbol of faith and cultural heritage.

The origins of the Kumbh Mela trace back to Hindu mythology, specifically the legend of Samudra Manthan, or the churning of the ocean. Going back to the time of Samudra Manthan, the word Kumbh was coined, which is very ancient. According to the ancestors of Sanatana Dharma, during Samudra Manthan, divine nectar (Amrit) was obtained. Due to this nectar, an epic battle occurred between the Devas and Asuras. The nectar had to be protected by the Devas, so it was given to four powerful Devas: Brihaspati (Jupiter), Surya (Sun), Chandra (Moon), and Shani (Saturn). As all four Devas fled with the nectar, the Asuras or Demons had to chase them unsuccessfully for 12 days and nights. This event took place at four locations: Haridwar, Prayagraj, Ujjain, and Nashik.

HISTORY OF MAHA KUMBH MELA

The Kumbh festival is organised and celebrated every 12 years at these four places. That's why it is a significant event for Sanatan Dharma, occurring every 12 years, and after 144 years, the Mahakumbh 2025 was celebrated.

According to ancient scriptures, this celestial event was a collaborative effort between the Devas (gods) and Asuras (demons) to retrieve Amrit, the nectar of immortality. A Kumbh (pot) filled with sacred nectar emerged during the process. To safeguard it from the demons, Lord Vishnu, disguised as Mohini, seized the pot and fled. Along his journey, a few drops of the nectar spilt at four places: Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ujjain, and Nashik, making them holy sites for the Kumbh Mela. These four sites became sacred, hosting the Kumbh Mela on a rotating basis. Significantly, the legend of Samudra Manthan is an important part of Hindu mythology, symbolising the struggle between good and evil.

Types of Kumbh	Description
Maha Kumbh Mela	• The Maha Kumbh Mela is the rarest and most sacred gathering. • It is held only in Prayagraj. • It comes every 144 years or after 12 Purna (Complete) Kumbh Mela. Purna Kumbh Mela.
Purna Kumbh Mela	• It comes every 12 years. • Mainly held at 4 Kumbh Mela Places in India, i.e. Prayagraj, Haridwar, Nashik and Ujjain.
Ardh Kumbh Mela	• Ardh Kumbh means Half Kumbh Mela, a fair which is held every 6 years in India only at two places, i.e. Haridwar and Prayagraj. • Held at four different places and organised by the state governments. • Millions of people participate with spiritual enthusiasm.
Magh Kumbh Mela	• Magh Kumbh is also known as Mini Kumbh Mela, which is held annually and only at Prayagraj. • It is organised in the month of Magh according to the Hindu Calendar.

SIGNIFICANCE OF MAHA KUMBH MELA

Prayagraj (formerly Allahabad) holds immense spiritual significance due to its mythological roots and geography. It is home to the Triveni Sangam, the sacred confluence of the Ganga, Yamuna, and the mythical Saraswati rivers, revered as one of Hinduism's holiest sites. The Kumbh Mela follows a 12-year cycle based on the celestial positions of the Sun, Moon, and Jupiter. Kumbh Mela, in Hinduism, is a religious pilgrimage celebrated four times over 12 years. The geographical location of Kumbh Mela spans over four locations in India, and the Mela site keeps rotating between one of the four pilgrimages on four sacred rivers, namely:

- **In Haridwar,** Uttarakhand, on the banks of Ganges
- **In Ujjain,** Madhya Pradesh on the banks of Shipra
- **In Nashik,** Maharashtra on the banks of Godavari
- **In Prayagraj,** Uttar Pradesh, at the confluence of the Ganges, the Yamuna, and the mythical invisible Sarasvati

MAHA KUMBH MELA: KEY RITUALS

At the heart of the Maha Kumbh Mela lies a series of sacred rituals and traditions, each imbued with profound spiritual significance. The Shahi Snan, or royal bath, is a sacred dip performed by saints, including Naga Sadhus and spiritual leaders, in the holy rivers. This ritual is believed to cleanse sins and bestow divine blessings upon the participants. Sankirtan and bhajans, devotional songs and hymns, fill the atmosphere with spiritual energy and devotion, while yoga and meditation sessions provide pilgrims with an opportunity to achieve physical, mental, and spiritual wellbeing. Spiritual discourses, led by renowned scholars and spiritual leaders, offer insights into religion, spirituality, and life.

Pilgrims to the Kumbh Mela come from all sections of the society, ranging from sadhus (saints) and Naga sadhus who practice 'sadhana' and strictly follow a strict path of spiritual discipline, to hermits who leave their seclusion and come to visit the civilisation only during the Kumbh Mela, to seekers of spirituality, and common people practising Hinduism. During the Kumbh Mela, several ceremonies take place: the traditional procession of Akharas called 'Peshwai' on elephant backs, horses and chariots, the shining swords and rituals of Naga sadhus during 'Shahi Snaan', and many other cultural activities that attract millions of pilgrims to attend the Kumbh Mela.

THE SYMBOLISM OF MAHA KUMBH

At the heart of the Maha Kumbh Mela lies a symbol steeped in cosmic significance, the "Kumbh" or sacred pot. This vessel, laden with symbolism, transcends its physical form to embody the human body and the quest for spiritual awakening. According to Hindu mythology, the Kumbh symbolises the celestial pot that emerged during the churning of the cosmic ocean, containing the divine nectar known as "amrita." Metaphorically, the Maha Kumbh represents the human form, and the nectar within symbolises the spiritual essence intrinsic to every individual. The pilgrimage to the Maha Kumbh Mela is, therefore, more than a physical journey; it is a symbolic exploration of the self, a recognition of the sacredness inherent in every being.

THE SACRED DIP: A RITUAL OF PURIFICATION AND RENEWAL

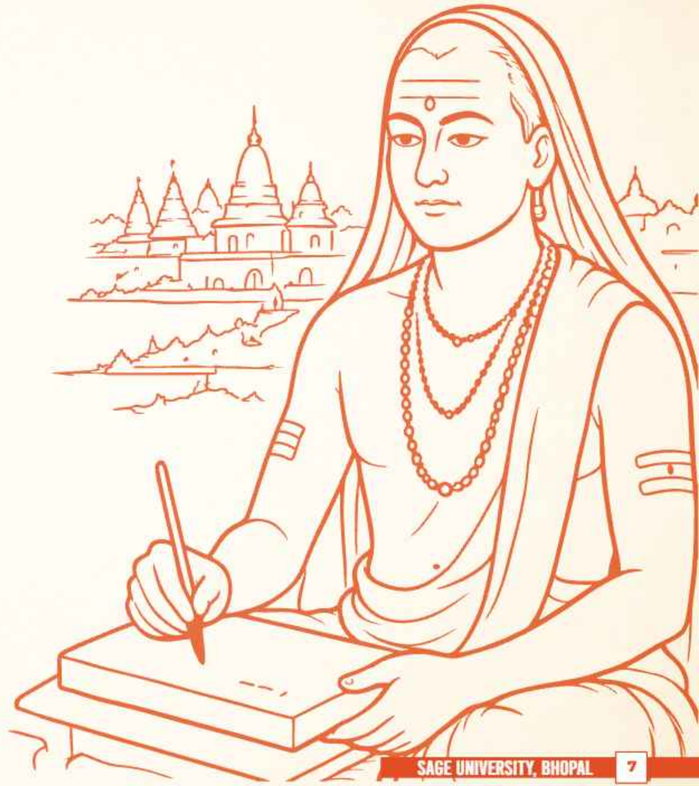
At the heart of the Maha Kumbh Mela lies a symbol steeped in cosmic significance, the "Kumbh" or sacred pot. This vessel, laden with symbolism, transcends its physical form to embody the human body and the quest for spiritual awakening. According to Hindu mythology, the Kumbh symbolises the celestial pot that emerged during the churning of the cosmic ocean, containing the divine nectar known as "amrita." Metaphorically, the Maha Kumbh represents the human form, and the nectar within symbolises the spiritual essence intrinsic to every individual. The pilgrimage to the Maha Kumbh Mela is, therefore, more than a physical journey; it is a symbolic exploration of the self, a recognition of the sacredness inherent in every being.

UNITY IN DIVERSITY: A CONFLUENCE OF SOULS

The Kumbh Mela stands as a unique tapestry where threads of diverse cultures, languages, and traditions seamlessly intertwine. It is a testament to the principle of unity in diversity. Pilgrims, irrespective of their background, come together in a celebration of shared spirituality, fostering a sense of brotherhood that transcends societal boundaries. In a world marked by divisions, the Kumbh Mela serves as a living embodiment of the idea that, beyond our differences, there exists a common thread that binds humanity a thread woven with the fabric of spiritual seeking.

महाकुंभ कब से शुरु हुआ?

- महाकुंभ की परंपरा हजारों वर्ष पुरानी है।
- इसका उल्लेख ऋग्वेद, पुराणों और कई प्राचीन ग्रंथों में मिलता है।
- माना जाता है कि यह परंपरा कम से कम 5000 वर्ष पुरानी है।
- वर्तमान स्वरूप में कुंभ मेले की शुरुआत आदि शंकराचार्य जी ने 8वीं शताब्दी में की थी।



CULTURAL EXTRAVAGANZA: BEYOND RITUALS AND RHYTHMS

The Kumbh Mela is not merely a religious congregation; it is a vibrant cultural extravaganza, showcasing the rich tapestry of India's cultural heritage. Traditional music, infused with devotional lyrics, serves as a medium for spiritual expression, while artisans from across the country showcase their crafts, creating a melting pot of cultural exchange and creativity. The air is filled with the sweet scent of incense and the sound of devotional songs, as pilgrims and artisans alike come together to celebrate the rich cultural heritage of India.

GLOBAL PILGRIMAGE: A SPIRITUAL HARMONY ACROSS BORDERS

In an era of globalisation, the Maha Kumbh Mela has evolved into a global pilgrimage. Pilgrims and spiritual seekers from around the world make the journey to the sacred grounds, transcending geographical and cultural boundaries. This grand event has become a meeting point for diverse perspectives, fostering an environment conducive to the exchange of ideas and the promotion of global spiritual harmony. The global participation in the Maha Kumbh Mela underscores its universal appeal, recognising that, despite the diversity of paths, there exists a shared yearning for the transcendent, a common thread that binds individuals on their respective spiritual journeys.

THE INNER JOURNEY: A PILGRIMAGE OF THE SOUL

As we delve into the profound inner meaning of the Maha Kumbh Mela, it becomes evident that this gathering is not merely a congregation; it is an inner journey. It is an exploration of the self, a purification of the soul, and a celebration of our shared humanity. The Kumbh Mela transcends the physical rituals and ceremonies; it is an inner pilgrimage where individuals, amidst the vastness of the congregation, seek a personal connection with the divine. In the convergence of millions, may we find not just a collective of bodies, but a symphony of spirits resonating with the eternal quest for truth and enlightenment.

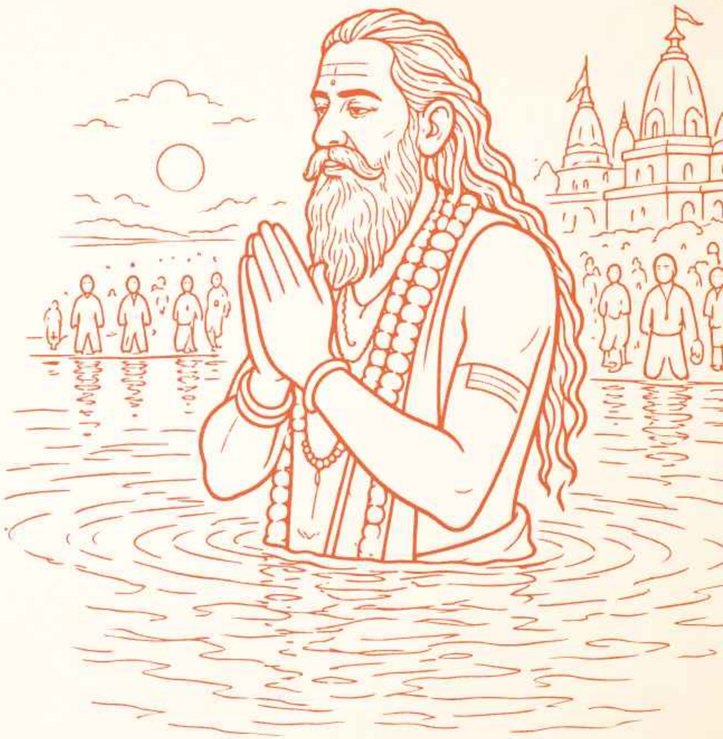
Speaking of Prayagraj, the venue of Maha Kumbh Mela, 2025, has much more to offer, including:

- **Temples:** Embark on a spiritual odyssey by exploring the revered temples of Prayagraj, such as the Hanuman Mandir, Alopi Devi Mandir, and Mankameshwar Temple, each steeped in history and religious significance, offering a profound glimpse into the city's spiritual heritage.
- **Historical Landmarks:** Unveil the secrets of India's rich historical past by discovering the Ashoka Pillar, an ancient edifice that stands as a testament to the nation's glorious heritage. Delve into the inscriptions and significance of this monumental structure, and marvel at its enduring legacy.
- **Colonial Architecture:** Prayagraj boasts an impressive array of Colonial-era buildings, with the University of Allahabad Building and Swaraj Bhawan being notable examples. These structures provide a fascinating glimpse into the city's colonial history and architectural grandeur, showcasing the unique blend of Indian and European styles.
- **Cultural Heritage:** Beyond the Maha Kumbh Mela, Prayagraj's cultural heritage is on full display, awaiting exploration. Immerse yourself in the local culture, art, and cuisine as you traverse the bustling streets and markets, discovering the city's vibrant spirit and warm hospitality.
- **Educational Institutions:** The city is also home to prestigious educational institutions, including the esteemed Allahabad University, which is revered as the Oxford University of the East. This venerable institution has played a significant role in India's intellectual history, shaping the minds of countless scholars and leaders who have contributed to the nation's growth and development.

The Maha Kumbh Mela, 2025, in particular, was a rare occasion, occurring once every 144 years. This unique alignment was believed to make it exceptionally propitious for prayers and rituals. Precisely the reason why millions of pilgrims took a once-in-a-lifetime holy dip in the sacred rivers in 2025, seeking purification and Moksha. Indeed, the Maha Kumbh Mela, 2025, stood tall as a testament to the enduring power of faith and the indefatigable human spirit.

महाकुंभ क्यों मनाया जाता है?

- यह पर्व आत्मशुद्धि, मोक्ष और पुण्य प्राप्ति के लिए मनाया जाता है।
- मान्यता है कि कुंभ के दौरान पवित्र नदियों में स्नान करने से सभी पाप धुल जाते हैं।
- यह सनातन धर्म, संस्कृति और एकता का प्रतीक है।
- यह दुनिया का सबसे बड़ा आध्यात्मिक और सांस्कृतिक आयोजन है।



SECTION 1: RELIGIOUS SIGNIFICANCE: ANCIENT MEETS MODERN

1.1 CONFLUENCE OF TRADITION AND INNOVATION

Indroduction

The 2025 Maha Kumbh Mela, held in Prayagraj, represented a pivotal moment in this tradition's evolution. As India had stridden into a digital age, the Kumbh was poised to integrate cutting-edge technology while grappling with challenges like environmental sustainability and overcrowding. This paper explored the Kumbh's origins in Vedic and Puranic traditions, its historical metamorphosis under successive empires, and its contemporary incarnation as a techno-spiritual marvel. By comparing ancient practices with modern innovations, this study illuminated how the Kumbh Mela remained a living bridge between India's past and future.

VEDIC FOUNDATIONS: THE SPIRITUAL BEDROCK

The Vedas (1500–500 BCE), Hinduism's oldest scriptures, laid the philosophical and ritualistic groundwork for the Kumbh Mela. These texts sanctified rivers as divine entities, codified rituals for cosmic harmony, and institutionalised mass gatherings as acts of communal spirituality.

Rigveda (RV 10.75): Rivers as Divine Purifiers

The Nadistuti Sukta (Hymn to the Rivers) in the Rigveda (10.75) venerated seven sacred rivers, including the Saraswati and Ganga, as goddesses who purified the earth and mediated between heaven and humanity. The hymn declared: "hese rivers, like mothers, nourish us; they flow ceaselessly, their voices resounding like chariots in battle"(RV 10.75.1). The Saraswati, though geographically extinct, was hailed as the "oremost of rivers,"symbolising the eternal flow of wisdom. This reverence for rivers as life-givers and purifiers underpinned the Kumbh' ritual baths, where pilgrims sought to dissolve karmic burdens.

Yajurveda (YV 19.87): Rituals for Cosmic Order

The Yajurveda, a manual for Vedic rituals, prescribed yagnas (fire sacrifices) performed on riverbanks to align human actions with rita (cosmic order). The Taitiriya Samhita (YV 4.5) emphasised snan (ablutions) in sacred waters as a means of inner purification, stating: "s water cleanses the body, so truth cleanses the mind."These rituals, conducted by Brahmin priests, were believed to sustain ecological and spiritual equilibrium, a concept mirrored in the Kumbh' structured ceremonies.

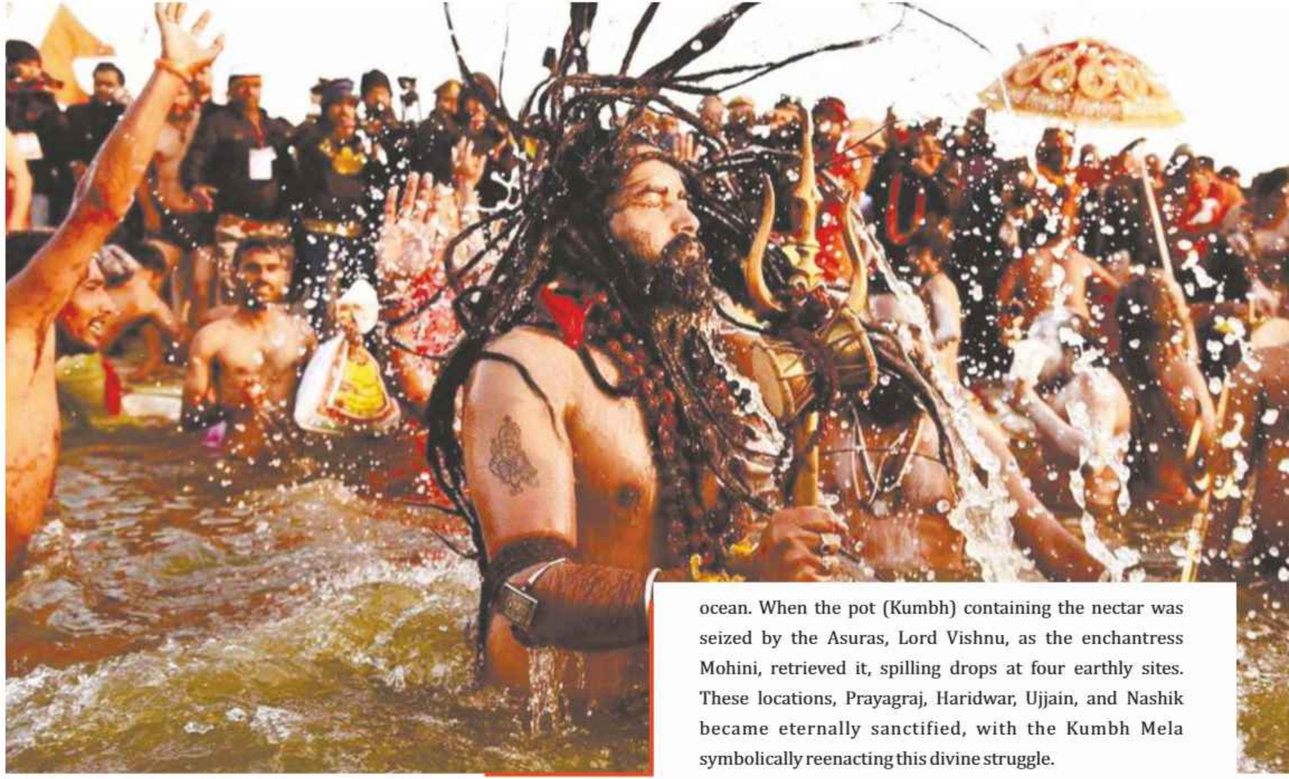
Atharvaveda (AV 11.7.1): Communal Unity

The Atharvaveda highlighted the societal role of mass gatherings (samelans), where collective prayers amplified spiritual merit. Kanda 14 described large-scale rituals for communal well-being, including chants (saman) and offerings to river deities. The text asserted: "n unity, there is strength; in congregation, there is divine grace"(AV 11.7.1). This ethos of inclusivity persisted in the Kumbh, where millions from diverse castes and regions converged in shared devotion.

Synthesis: The Vedas established a tripartite foundation of sacred hydrology, ritual-cosmic synergy, and communal unity that continued to animate the Kumbh Mela' philosophy.

Puranic Mythology: Cosmic Narratives and Astrology

The Puranas (300–000 CE) expanded the Kumbh' mythological and astrological dimensions, embedding it in Hindu cosmology.



Bhagavata Purana (BhP 8.7–1): The Churning of the Ocean

The Samudra Manthan myth, detailed in the Bhagavata Purana, recounts the celestial collaboration and conflict between Devas (gods) and Asuras (demons) to extract Amrita from the cosmic ocean. When the pot (Kumbh) containing the nectar was seized by the Asuras, Lord Vishnu, as the enchantress Mohini, retrieved it, spilling drops at four earthly sites. These locations, Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ujjain, and Nashik became eternally sanctified, with the Kumbh Mela symbolically reenacting this divine struggle.

Matsya Purana (MP 107.5–): Astrological Governance

The Matsya Purana linked the Kumbh' timing to planetary alignments: Jupiter in Aquarius (Kumbha Rashi) and the

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Bhagavata Purana (BhP 8.7–1): The Churning of the Ocean

The Samudra Manthan myth, detailed in the Bhagavata Purana, recounts the celestial collaboration and conflict between Devas (gods) and Asuras (demons) to extract Amrita from the cosmic ocean. When the pot (Kumbh) containing the nectar was seized by the Asuras, Lord Vishnu, as the enchantress Mohini, retrieved it, spilling drops at four earthly sites. These locations, Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ujjain, and Nashik became eternally sanctified, with the Kumbh Mela symbolically reenacting this divine struggle.

Matsya Purana (MP 107.5–): Astrological Governance

The Matsya Purana linked the Kumbh' timing to planetary

Maha Kumbh 2025: Technology, Economy, and Challenges

Technological Integration

AI and IoT: Drones with thermal imaging monitor crowd density, while IBM' Smart Kumbh app provides real-time navigation. RFID wristbands track pilgrims'health data, alerting medics to emergencies.

Virtual Participation: Meta' VR platforms offer immersive darshan (sacred viewing), while 4K live streams enable global participation. In 2013, live broadcasts reached 20 million viewers; 2025 aims for 100 million.

Socio-Economic Impact

Tourism: Projections estimate 50–0 million visitors, generating $1.8 billion through luxury tents ($500/night) and premium packages. The Uttar Pradesh government has allocated ₹,500 crore ($300 million) for infrastructure, including 10,000 bio-toilets and expanded airport facilities.

Employment: Over 600,000 temporary jobs are created, with daily wages ranging from ₹00 for sanitation workers to ₹,000 for multilingual guides.

Environmental Strain: The 2019 Kumbh generated 4,000 tonnes of daily waste, raising the Ganga' BOD to 7.8 mg/L (safe limit: 3 mg/L). For 2025, biodegradable offerings and 15 mobile sewage plants aim to reduce pollution.

Security: NSG commandos and facial recognition systems screen 1.5 million visitors daily, balancing openness with anti-terror measures.

Commercialisation: VIP passes (₹0,000–₹0,000) risk excluding marginalised groups, prompting calls for free-access zones.

Spiritual Continuity in a Changing World

At its core, the Kumbh Mela remains anchored in its Vedic-Puranic roots, the pursuit of moksha (liberation) through sacred river baths, the cosmic symbolism of planetary alignments, and the communal ethos of sangam (confluence). These elements, unchanged for millennia, continue to draw millions seeking transcendence. The Shahi Snan (royal bath) of 2025, though monitored by drones and AI, retains the same ritual fervour as described in the Matsya Purana. The chants of "*Har Gange*" echo as they did in Hiuen Tsang' accounts, bridging epochs through unwavering faith.

Technological Integration: A Double-Edged Sword

The 2025 Kumbh' embrace of technology, AI crowd control, VR darshan, and IoT-enabled infrastructure demonstrates adaptive resilience. Yet, this progress is not without paradox. While virtual participation democratises access for global devotees, it risks reducing the pilgrimage to a

digital spectacle. Similarly, RFID wristbands enhance safety but could commodify spirituality, as seen in premium-priced "IP passes."The challenge lies in ensuring technology amplifies, rather than dilutes, the Kumbh' sacred intent.

Ecological and Ethical Imperatives

The environmental toll of previous Kumbhs, polluted rivers, and mountains of plastic waste demands urgent action. The 2025 festival' initiatives, such as bio-degradable offerings and sewage treatment plants, are laudable but incremental.

Zero-Waste Mandates: Enforce strict penalties for non-biodegradable materials. Transition to fully compostable or reusable items for all offerings and packaging.

Carbon Neutrality: Transition fully to solar energy for lighting and water pumps. Implement electric or biofuel-powered transportation for pilgrims.

River Rejuvenation: Partner with NGOs for year-round river clean-up, not just during the Kumbh. Implement sustainable water management practices to maintain the Ganga' ecological balance.

Inclusive Sustainability: Ensure marginalised communities benefit from eco-initiatives. Provide affordable, eco-friendly

accommodations and promote local artisans using sustainable materials.

Its success hinges on:

Public-Private Partnerships: Leverage corporate CSR funds for eco-infrastructure. Collaborate with tech firms to develop scalable solutions for crowd management and waste reduction.

Inter-faith Collaboration: Invite global religious leaders to dialogue on sustainable pilgrimage practices. Share best practices for minimising environmental impact while preserving spiritual essence.

The Maha Kumbh Mela: A Mirror Reflecting India' Soul: The Maha Kumbh Mela is more than a festival; it is a mirror reflecting India' soul, ancient yet dynamic, chaotic yet cohesive. As 2025 unfolds, it carries the weight of history and the promise of innovation. By marrying tradition with sustainability and inclusivity, the Kumbh can illuminate a path for humanity' collective spiritual journey in the Anthropocene era.

Conclusion

It is said in the Rigveda (10.75.1), "he rivers, the mothers of abundance, flow ceaselessly toward the ocean of unity."So too must the Kumbh flow, uniting the past and the future in its sacred waters. By embracing radical sustainability, technological innovation, and inclusive practices, the Maha Kumbh Mela can continue to thrive as a beacon of spiritual continuity and environmental stewardship. enhance safety but could commodify spirituality, as

1.2 ECHOES OF DEVOTION SPANNING GENERATIONS

Introduction

As discussed earlier, the 2025 Maha Kumbh at Prayagraj became an exceptional and unparalleled experience due to the rare celestial alignment that occurred only once every 144 years. This cosmic phenomenon enhanced its significance, making it a unique experience of deep spiritual resonance. It was addressed as a once-in-a-lifetime chance to attain spiritual enlightenment, get rid of one's sins, and fulfil the enduring quest for Moksha. Furthermore, the Maha Kumbh became a meeting ground for diverse linguistic, cultural, and societal expressions, with its influence extending to literature, language, and social interactions alongside its evolving significance in a digital age, where media and social platforms shaped perceptions globally.

The significance of the Maha Kumbh, however, went beyond the act of spiritual purification; it accelerated art, literature, and popular culture, apart from leaving immediate festive fervours. It served as a dynamic force full of spiritual grandeur, inspiring countless poets, storytellers, writers, and artists over the centuries. From mythical folklores, traditional folk songs, and devotional music to contemporary art and photography, the Kumbh Mela stimulated the imagination of creators across different media. It reflected India's rich cultural heritage and beliefs while fostering language and literature in contemporary society. The Maha Kumbh served as both a reflection of traditional and modern forms of literary expression and a catalyst for the evolution of language and literature in contemporary society.

Exploring Mythical and Historical Roots

The earliest references to the Kumbh Mela were found in ancient Hindu scriptures, such as the Puranas and the Mahabharata. The Rigveda, one of the oldest sacred texts of Hinduism, also mentions the ritual of bathing in sacred rivers to wash away sins and attain spiritual purity. Over time, these references evolved into the grand festival that is now known as the Kumbh Mela. The legend associated with the origins of the Kumbh Mela was steeped in Hindu mythology, particularly the story of the Samudra Manthan, the churning of the

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Literature at the Mahakumbh: From Sacred Texts to Modern Narratives

The Maha Kumbh was immortalised in literature for centuries, both in classical religious texts and modern works. In ancient scriptures, the Kumbh was frequently mentioned as a symbol of cosmic renewal, with poets and mystics composing hymns and verses that elevated the event to divine significance. These texts, often composed in Sanskrit or early vernacular forms, inspired generations of writers and scholars, shaping literary views of the Kumbh. In English literature, the Kumbh Mela was the backdrop for numerous stories, poems, and essays that explored themes of faith, devotion, and the human condition. These creative narratives woven around the Kumbh Mela helped keep its spiritual significance and vibrant atmosphere alive in the public consciousness long after the event concluded, contributing to its enduring legacy.

Among the early Indian writings, Raja Rao's novel "*The Serpent and the Rope*" presented the protagonist's spiritual journey intertwined with the ethos of the Kumbh Mela. Here, Raja Rao emphasised the festival's symbolic representation of rebirth, cleansing, and self-discovery. Another writer, Amitav Ghosh, in his novel "*The River of Smoke*," portrayed the Kumbh Mela as a meeting ground for diverse characters, thereby representing this festival as a cultural melting point. In contemporary literature, the Maha Kumbh continued to draw imagery and spiritual significance to create narratives that resonated with readers. Modern literary forms like travelogues, memoirs, and essays captured the grandeur of the Maha Kumbh, with authors weaving personal reflections on the event alongside broader cultural analyses. Popular and mythological fiction writers like Devdutt Pattanaik and Amish Tripathi explored the rich tapestry of the mythical beauty of the Kumbh Mela.

Aparna Kala's popular fiction "*Life..Love..Kumbh..*" (2011) described the lives of three individuals intersecting during the Kumbh Mela as they grappled with questions of life, love, and the search for inner knowledge amidst the backdrop of the sacred gathering. In 2025, the Mahakumbh's influence on literature likely expanded even further. The advent of digital media and self-publishing platforms allowed a new generation of writers to document their experiences at the Kumbh, adding to the literary tapestry of this grand event. Through blogs, social media posts, and vlogs, individuals shaped an entirely new form of literary expression, one that combined the spiritual with the personal and the immediate.

The Language of the Mahakumbh: A Dialogue of Devotion

The languages that permeated the Maha Kumbh were as diverse as the gathering itself. The most prominent of these was Sanskrit, the ancient language of the Vedas and the basis of many rituals and mantras recited during the event. The Maha Kumbh acted as a living testament to the power of sacred language in maintaining spiritual continuity and identity. Sanskrit mantras echoed in the air, and religious leaders, ascetics, and spiritual gurus invoked the divine using this revered tongue. In contrast, the language of the Maha Kumbh was not confined to ancient tongues. Hindi and regional dialects such as Awadhi, Bhojpuri, and Maithili were commonly spoken by the pilgrims who travelled from across the country.

The use of these dialects introduced a unique fusion of sacred and vernacular expressions, allowing the spiritual message of the Kumbh to resonate with a broader demographic.

The experience of the Maha Kumbh, as understood through these languages, was inclusive, transcending barriers of caste, class, and region, and inviting all individuals into a shared cultural space. Language at the Maha Kumbh was also used to foster communication between the local and the visiting populations. The coming together of people from different linguistic backgrounds often led to a hybridisation of language, as visitors from urban areas conversed with rural populations, sharing stories and creating new colloquial expressions that reflected the event' collective spirt.

Social Impact: Unity in Diversity

The Maha Kumbh served as a remarkable example of India' pluralistic society, where the diversity Social Impact: Unity in Diversity

The Maha Kumbh served as a remarkable example of India's pluralistic society, where the diversity of languages, cultures, and religions blended harmoniously. People from all corners of India, urban and rural, wealthy and poor, devout and secular, came together, united by their common purpose of seeking spiritual rejuvenation. This convergence created an environment of social cohesion that transcended divisions. The social dynamics of the Maha Kumbh also extended to the role of language. While many pilgrims spoke in their local dialects, the common language of spirituality bound them together. Pilgrims shared their experiences, communicated their faith, and engaged in communal rituals, all of which fostered a sense of shared identity.

The Maha Kumbh became a space where language became a bridge, connecting individuals who may have never interacted outside the context of the event. The influence of the Maha Kumbh also reached beyond religious participants. The media plays a crucial role in broadcasting the event to global audiences, and the portrayal of the Kumbh through media outlets often highlights themes of unity and spiritual harmony. Journalists, photographers, and content creators shaped a global narrative of India' rich cultural and spiritual diversity.

Digital Age and the Globalisation of the Mahakumbh

In an era where technology and media shaped perceptions of the world, the Maha Kumbh entered the digital space, altering the way the event was perceived and experienced. Social media platforms buzzed with real-time updates, photographs, and stories from pilgrims, ascetics, and visitors. These narratives added a contemporary dimension to the Maha Kumbh, offering a real-time connection between the event and its global audience.

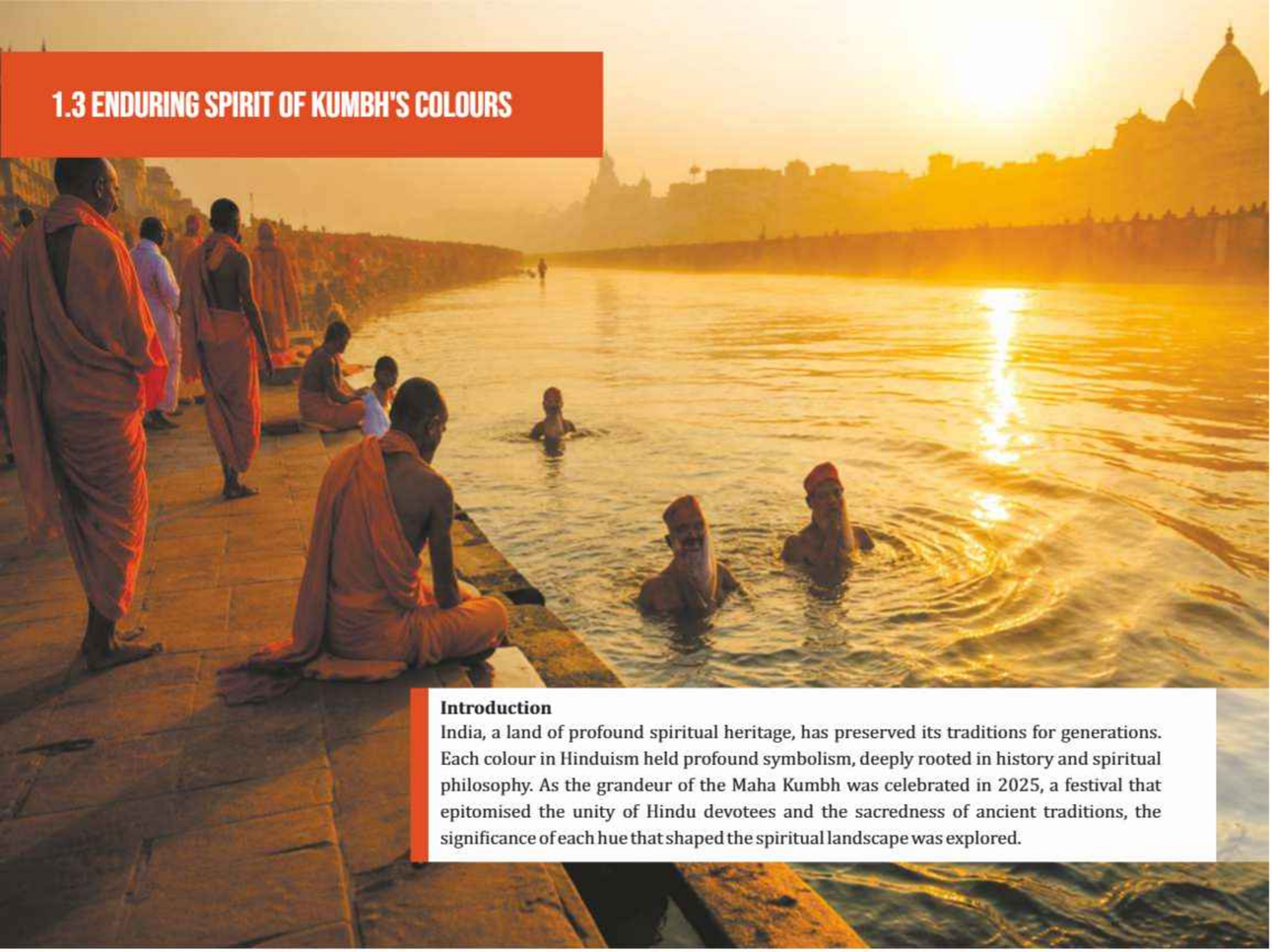
The impact of the Maha Kumbh on digital content was profound, as individuals around the world engaged with it not just through passive observation but through active participation in the online narrative. Social media influencers, bloggers, and documentary filmmakers created new forms of digital literature that captured the spiritual and social aspects of the event. This digital narrative reshaped how the Maha Kumbh was perceived in the global imagination.

Conclusion: The Kumbh' Enduring Legacy in Language, Literature, and Society

z As the 2025 Maha Kumbh ended, it was clear that the event had continued to shape the linguistic, literary, and social fabric of India. The languages spoken at the Kumbh, ancient and modern, reflected the depth and diversity of India' spiritual heritage. The literature inspired by the Maha Kumbh, both classical and contemporary, served as a testament to the enduring relevance of the event in shaping India' cultural narrative.

The social unity fostered by the Maha Kumbh, expressed through language and shared rituals, continued to serve as a powerful reminder of the importance of communal harmony in an increasingly fragmented world. In the years that followed, the Maha Kumbh would undoubtedly continue to be a touchstone for cultural expression, linguistic creativity, and societal cohesion. It remained a unique confluence of the sacred and the secular, where language, literature, and society converged in the most profound of ways.

1.3 ENDURING SPIRIT OF KUMBH'S COLOURS



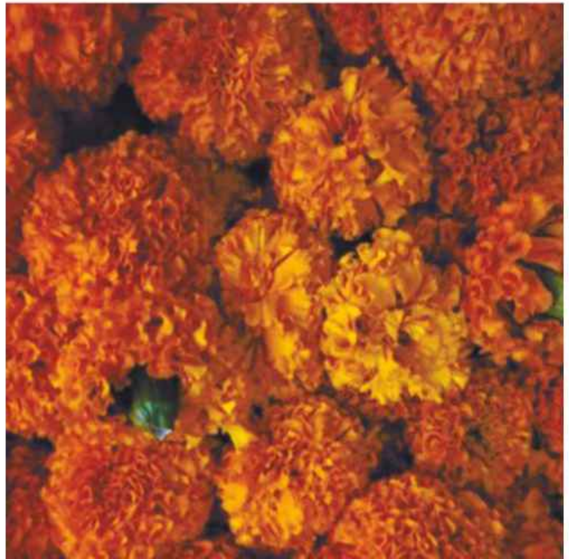
Introduction

India, a land of profound spiritual heritage, has preserved its traditions for generations. Each colour in Hinduism held profound symbolism, deeply rooted in history and spiritual philosophy. As the grandeur of the Maha Kumbh was celebrated in 2025, a festival that epitomised the unity of Hindu devotees and the sacredness of ancient traditions, the significance of each hue that shaped the spiritual landscape was explored.

Symbolism:

Saffron: Saffron was a symbol of renunciation, purity, and the search for spiritual enlightenment. It represented the solitary path taken by a seeker who gave up materialistic desires. The pilgrim's spiritual journey was mirrored by this colour's instillation of devotion, selflessness, and detachedness.

- ***Effect:*** The pilgrim's spiritual journey is mirrored by this colour's instillation of devotion, selflessness, and detachedness. It embodies the essence of standing before the divine with humility, free from the bonds of materialism.



White: White denoted purity, peace, and divine truth. It signified the accomplishment of spiritual enlightenment and the transcendence of egotistical desires. The Kumbh Mela's ritualistic bathing in sacred waters was centred on the promotion of inner peace, tranquillity, and spiritual purification.

- **Effect:** The Kumbh Mela's ritualistic bathing in sacred waters is centred on the promotion of inner peace, tranquillity, and spiritual purification. In Hindu tradition, mourners wear white to symbolise the soul's journey beyond the material world and the ultimate truth of mortality.

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Blue: The colour blue was associated with Lord Vishnu and represented the vastness of the universe, a representation of the divine's infinite and all-encompassing nature. This colour promoted introspection, stability, and trust in divine guidance.

Effect: This colour promotes introspection, stability, and trust in divine guidance. It helps devotees surrender themselves to higher spiritual forces, embracing the cosmic order and universal truth

Red: Red signified power, energy, and the life force (Shakti). It stood for zeal, power, and transformation. Vivacity of red inspired devotion and spiritual fervour, causing it to transform.

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Effect: The vivacity of red inspires devotion and spiritual fervour, causing people to transform. It is often used in religious ceremonies, weddings, and rituals that invoke divine energy and protection.

Yellow: Yellow was associated with knowledge, wisdom, and divine teachings, particularly of Lord Vishnu and Lord Krishna. It stood for the light of learning and truth-seeking. Optimism, spiritual clarity, and enlightenment were cultivated by this colour.

Effect: Optimism, spiritual clarity, and enlightenment are cultivated by this colour. Saints and scholars often wear yellow

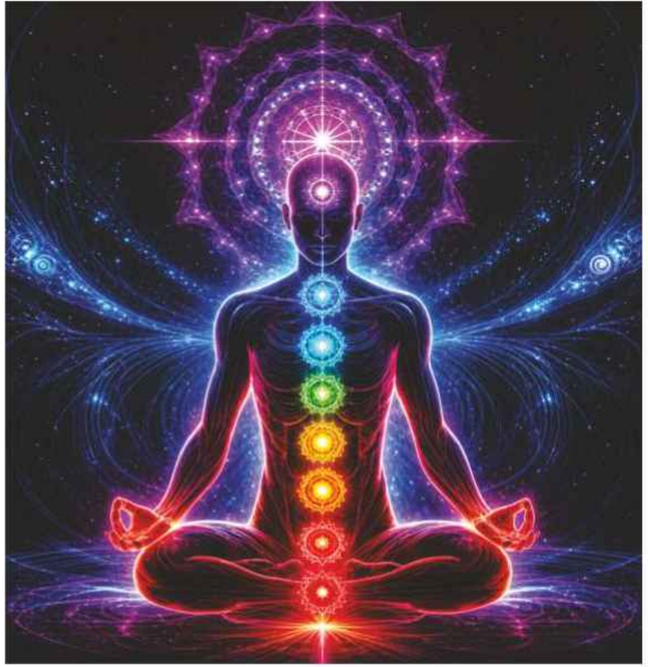
Saffron as a Spiritual Symbol

In Hindu tradition, saffron was closely associated with Agni (the Fire God), a fundamental element in spiritual practices. Colours carried intrinsic meanings, influencing both mental and physical states.Saffron's spiritual significance was multifaceted:

- Saffron represented sacrifice and reverence for Agni, as mentioned in the Rig Veda.
- Sandhya (the time between sunrise and sunset) and Agni (energy and transformation) were both represented by saffron.
- Fire (Agni) purified and dissolved attachments to the outside world, and saffron-clad ascetics demonstrated their detachment from material desires.
- Wearing saffron signified a commitment to living a virtuous life, and fire represented purity. Wearing saffron signifies a commitment to living a virtuous life, and fire represents purity. Agni reduces all to ashes, reminding individuals of life's impermanence and the transient nature of material possessions.
- Fire transforms whatever it consumes into purity, reinforcing the ascetic's journey toward spiritual elevation. As a result, saffron represents repentance, tranquillity, purity, simplicity, and devotion.

Scientific Perspective on Saffron

Colours have profound psychological and physiological effects.



Studies suggest that colours can influence mood, energy levels, and even health. Saffron, in particular, is known to emit vibrations that may counteract negative energies and promote well-being. Colours had profound psychological and physiological effects. Studies suggested that colours could influence mood, energy levels, and even health. Saffron, in particular, was known to emit vibrations that may counteract negative energies and promote well-being.

- The human body was governed by seven primary chakras, each associated with a distinct colour.
- Saffron was closely linked to colour vibration theory, which posited that colours generated electrical signals on the retina, transmitting them to the brain.
- The Swadhisthana chakra, associated with health and vitality, corresponded directly to the colour saffron. Wearing saffron was believed to aid in healing ailments related to the kidneys, colon, and urinary bladder.

Interconnectedness of colours with Mental Peace

Colours not only influence traditions and emotions but also play a crucial role in maintaining a happy state of mind. In today's fast-paced, stress-filled world, colours significantly impact mental well-being. Each colour in the spectrum has a unique frequency and wavelength, affecting both the body and mind in different ways. While some colours energise and uplift, others create a sense of calm and relaxation. Colour therapy, also known as chromotherapy, harnesses the power of colours to support mental, emotional, and physical well-being.

Thus, by understanding the psychological and physiological effects of different colours, individuals can use colour therapy more effectively to create visually appealing spaces and enhance overall mood and health.

Benefits of Colour Therapy

1. **Pain Relief:** Research suggests that certain colours can help reduce pain. Green, in particular, has a soothing effect on physical discomfort. Exposure to green environments, such as nature or green-painted rooms, can promote relaxation and alleviate pain.

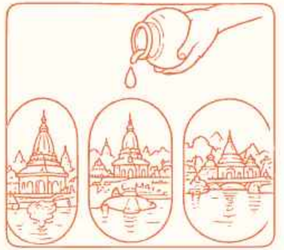
2. **Improved Sleep:** Colours play a key role in sleep quality. While blue light from screens can disrupt sleep patterns, incorporating darker shades of blue or soft greens in your bedroom can create a calming atmosphere, reduce stress, and prepare the mind for rest.
3. **Enhanced Focus and Concentration:** Vibrant colours like yellow are known to boost cognitive function, alertness, and focus. These colours are ideal for study areas and workspaces where concentration is essential.
4. **Increased Appetite:** Warm colours like red and orange stimulate appetite, making them beneficial in dining areas. This effect can be particularly useful for individuals struggling with appetite issues.
5. **Boosted Energy Levels:** Red and orange are energizing colours that can uplift the mind and body. Whether through clothing, home decor, or lighting, these colours can help improve vitality and motivation.
6. **Stress and Anxiety Reduction:** Shades of blue and green are known for their calming effects. These colours can help lower stress and anxiety, making them ideal for relaxation spaces such as bedrooms, meditation areas, and wellness centres.

महाकुंभ की पौराणिक कथा

देवताओं और असुरों ने समुद्र मंथन किया।

मंथन से अमृत कलश (कुंभ) निकला।

अमृत कलश को लेकर देवताओं और असुरों में 12 दिनों तक युद्ध हुआ। (देवताओं के 1 दिन = मनुष्यों के 1 वर्ष)



इस दौरान अमृत की कुछ बूंदें चार स्थानों पर गिरीं - प्रयागराज, हरिद्वार, उज्जैन और नासिक

तभी से इन चारों स्थानों पर कुंभ मेले की परंपरा चली आ रही है।

CHANGING FACE OF KUMBH SECTION 2:

2.1 AN INFRASTRUCTURE WOW

Indroduction

With over 64 crore pilgrims during the 2025 Maha Kumbh Mela, the demand for seamless transport, sanitation, accommodation, and security was supported by well-planned and developed infrastructure.

The Uttar Pradesh government recognised that comprehensive infrastructure development was key to making this global event both accessible and safe, and ensured that the spiritual significance of the gathering was matched by the quality of its organisational and logistical execution.

The city was transformed to accommodate the immense influx of pilgrims with state-of-the-art security measures like AI-powered surveillance and underwater drones, and massive infrastructure upgrades, including renovated roads, pontoon bridges, and a luxury tent city. Cutting-edge health services, environmental initiatives, and digital innovations enhanced the visitor experience, ensuring that faith and modernity went hand-in-hand.

Some Key Infrastructure Projects

In preparation for the 2025 Maha Kumbh, the government had launched several large-scale infrastructure projects to address the

needs of millions of pilgrims and visitors. The Mela area had expanded to a vast 4,000 hectares, marking a 25% increase from the previous Kumbh Mela in 2019. This expanded area was divided into 25 sectors, up from 20 in 2019, improving crowd management and accessibility.

Each sector functioned like a self-sustained municipal ward, complete with its own water supply, drainage, and waste management systems, ensuring smooth operations during the event.

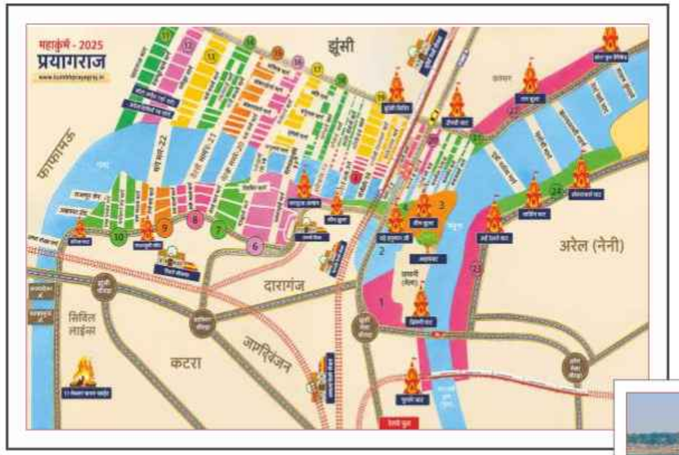
One of the most significant takeaways from Maha Kumbh 2025 has

been the lasting impact of infrastructure investments. The Uttar Pradesh government allocated ₹6,382 crore ($765 million) to enhance roads, bridges, sanitation, and public facilities in Prayagraj. Key projects, such as a six-lane bridge over the Ganga River and a ₹275 crore ($34 million) four-lane railway overbridge, significantly improved connectivity. Additionally, the mela grounds featured 150,000 toilets, 3,000 kitchens, and 11 hospitals to accommodate the massive crowd. These developments not only ensured a smoother event but will continue benefiting residents and visitors for years to come.

Connectivity and Transportation

Initially, critical rail and road projects worth ₹5,500 crore were inaugurated by the Prime Minister to improve connectivity to Prayagraj. This included the construction of 10 new Road Over Bridges (ROBs), flyovers, permanent ghats, and riverfront roads, ensuring smooth and fast movement of devotees. Additionally, temporary roads were extended by 35% to 400 km, facilitating easier access to the event grounds.

A total of 92 roads were renovated, with 17 major roads undergoing beautification. Furthermore, 30 pontoon bridges were constructed using 3,308 pontoons, 28 of which were already operational, providing easy access across the river and key areas. Over 2,69,000 checkered plates were laid to create smooth pedestrian pathways throughout the area.



Riverfront Development

To enhance the spiritual experience, the government had increased the number of Pucca Ghats from 4 to 9, and Pontoon bridges from 22 to 30. Such developments ensured that pilgrims had safe and convenient access to Sangam for ritual bathing. The Swachh and Nirmal Ganga initiative also remained central to the government's efforts, with projects focused on the interception, diversion, and treatment of drains leading to the river, ensuring zero untreated water discharge into the Ganga. A major priority for the Mela was preserving the sanctity of the Ganga.

Drone surveys had identified 81 drains that discharged waste into the river, with 37 drains already treated at Sewage Treatment Plants (STPs) in Prayagraj. Five drains with zero dry-weather flow were being addressed, while the remaining drains were tackled through geo-tube technology or by upgrading existing STPs. Two new STPs with a combined capacity of 133 MLD (90 MLD at Rajapur and 43 MLD at Salori) were finalized to ensure that no untreated wastewater entered the Ganga, in compliance with National Green Tribunal (NGT) standards.

Temporary City and Accommodations

One of the most significant developments for the event was the creation of Mahakumbh Nagar, a temporary city designed to host the influx of pilgrims. A temporary city was established on the banks of the Sangam, designed to accommodate millions of visitors over approximately 1.5 months.

This included modern amenities, temporary shelters, and dining facilities to cater to the influx of pilgrims. Over 10,000 organisations had set up camps, with 4,500 focused specifically on promoting Sanatan Dharma, creating a spiritually immersive environment for devotees. Thousands of tents and shelters were set up across the area, including high-end accommodations such as IRCTC's "Mahakumbh Gram" luxury tent city. This luxury setup offered deluxe tents and villas equipped with modern amenities, ensuring comfort for visitors seeking premium accommodations.

Sanitation and Cleanliness

Given the scale of the Mela, waste management was a key focus. The government had deployed over 15,000 sanitation workers to ensure cleanliness throughout the event. This comprehensive plan, implemented by the government, included jet spray cleaning systems, septic tanks, and soak pits. Furthermore, 55 vendors had been empanelled to provide community toilets, and all sanitation

Connectivity and Transportation

Initially, critical rail and road projects worth ₹5,500 crore were inaugurated by the Prime Minister to improve connectivity to Prayagraj. This included the construction of 10 new Road Over Bridges (ROBs), flyovers, permanent ghats, and riverfront roads, ensuring smooth and fast movement of devotees. Additionally, temporary roads were extended by 35% to 400 km, facilitating easier access to the event grounds.

A total of 92 roads were renovated, with 17 major roads undergoing beautification. Furthermore, 30 pontoon bridges were constructed using 3,308 pontoons, 28 of which were already operational, providing easy access across the river and key areas. Over 2,69,000 checkered plates were laid to create smooth pedestrian pathways throughout the area.

Riverfront Development

To enhance the spiritual experience, the government had increased the number of Pucca Ghats from 4 to 9, and Pontoon bridges from 22 to 30. Such developments ensured that pilgrims had safe and convenient access to Sangam for ritual bathing. The Swachh and Nirmal Ganga initiative also remained central to the government's efforts, with projects focused on the interception, diversion, and treatment of drains leading to the river, ensuring zero untreated water discharge into the Ganga. A major priority for the Mela was preserving the sanctity of the Ganga.

Drone surveys had identified 81 drains that discharged waste Treatment Plants (STPs) in Prayagraj. Five drains with zero dry-weather flow were being addressed, while the remaining drains were tackled through geo-tube technology or by upgrading existing STPs. Two new STPs with a combined capacity of 133 MLD (90 MLD at Rajapur and 43 MLD at Salori) were finalized to ensure that no untreated wastewater entered the Ganga, in compliance with National Green Tribunal (NGT) standards.

Temporary City and Accommodations

One of the most significant developments for the event was the creation of Mahakumbh Nagar, a temporary city designed to host the influx of pilgrims. A temporary city was established on the banks of the Sangam, designed to accommodate millions of visitors over approximately 1.5 months.

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2.2 USHERING IN DIGITAL INTERVENTIONS

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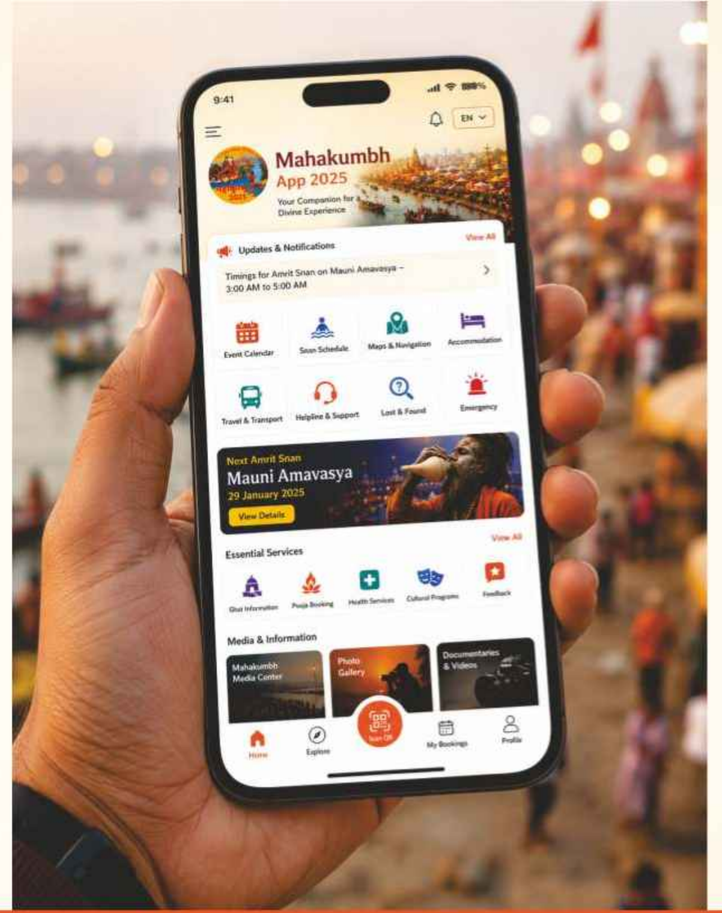

Authority, integrating the sprawling Mahakumbh area into Google Maps to enhance traffic management during Maha Kumbh 2025. Google has integrated the temporary tent city into its navigation system, allowing devotees to easily locate and navigate various ghats, akharas, and saints' camps. It aids pilgrims in locating major camps, pandals, mandapams, identifying pedestal main roads, various sectors, event hubs, Jan Aushadhi Kendras, saints' camps, toilets, food courts, pontoon bridges, emergency services and other essential services. Google Navigation delivered real-time, detailed information about routes and roads, traffic updates, alternate routes, and road closure information, helping pilgrims avoid congestion and reach their destinations smoothly. This marks the first time Google has integrated a temporary city into its navigation, highlighting the spiritual and logistical significance of the Kumbh Mela. These technological advancements have made MahaKumbh 2025 safer, more convenient, and user-friendly for millions of pilgrims. To address parking challenges, AI-driven smart parking systems have been deployed. Integration with Google Maps has allowed users to view and navigate to available parking spaces seamlessly. A network of over 2,750 AI-powered CCTV cameras had been installed to monitor crowd movements and

conjunction with the Kumbh Mela. Pilgrims had received real-time updates and notifications about ongoing and upcoming events, ensuring they remained informed about any changes in schedules or important announcements. This feature had been crucial for effective time management and participation in desired activities. To cater to the diverse demographic of attendees, the app had offered multilingual support, making information accessible to a broader audience and ensuring inclusivity.

Waste Management

The Uttar Pradesh government had meticulously implemented a comprehensive waste management strategy for the Prayagraj Maha Kumbh 2025, aiming to uphold cleanliness and environmental sustainability during the massive gathering.

Real-Time Cleanliness Monitoring: The administration had implemented real-time monitoring systems to oversee cleanliness and waste management activities.1000 cameras on RFID-based technology were installed to detect cleanliness at different locations. These cameras also detect the reach and frequency of cleansing vehicles and safai mitras daily. This approach facilitated prompt responses to sanitation issues, ensuring that high standards of hygiene were maintained consistently throughout the event.

Establishment of a Bio-CNG Plant: Before the event, a state-of-the-art Bio-CNG plant had been established in Naini, Prayagraj, with an investment of Rs. 177 crore. This facility had been designed to process 200 tons of organic waste daily, producing 21.5 tons of Bio-CNG and 200 tons of organic fertiliser each day. The plant had not only contributed to effective waste disposal but also generated an annual revenue of Rs. 56 lakh for the municipal corporation.

Implementation of Advanced Wastewater Treatment: Advanced wastewater treatment technologies, including mobile sewage treatment plants and decentralised treatment systems, have been employed to prevent contamination of the Ganges River. These systems ensured that wastewater was treated near its source, reducing the burden on centralised facilities and promoting the reuse of treated water for non-potable purposes such as irrigation and cleaning.

Deployment of Sanitation Infrastructure and Workforce

To manage the anticipated influx of over 400 million pilgrims, the administration had installed approximately 150,000 temporary toilets and urinals across the Kumbh Mela area. A dedicated team of 20,000 sanitation workers had been mobilised to maintain hygiene standards, with each worker assigned to specific zones to ensure efficient waste collection and disposal. The well-being of sanitation workers, referred to as 'Safai Mitras,' had been prioritised. The government had established sanitation colonies to provide proper housing and amenities, and primary schools had been set up for their children under the 'Vidya Kumbh' initiative. These measures ensured that workers received adequate support, including food, accommodation, and timely salary payments, acknowledging their crucial role in maintaining cleanliness during the event. One Bag, One Thali Initiative: To promote a plastic-free environment, the administration had launched the 'One Bag, One Thali' campaign. This initiative involved the distribution of 1.25 lakh steel plates and 20 lakh cloth bags to pilgrims and camps, encouraging the use of reusable items over disposable ones. The campaign aimed to minimise plastic waste and foster a culture of sustainability among attendees.

Daily River Water Quality Monitoring: Ensuring the sanctity and safety of the Ganges River, authorities had conducted daily water quality tests throughout the event. Teams from the Pollution Control Board had collected samples from various ghats to monitor pollution levels, ensuring the water remained safe for bathing and other religious activities. Recognising the environmental impact of ritual offerings, the administration had implemented systems for the continuous segregation and removal of flowers, coconuts, and other materials from the river. Specialised machines had been deployed to extract these items every two hours, preventing pollution and maintaining the river's cleanliness.

Logistics and Supply Chain Management

The Uttar Pradesh government had meticulously orchestrated a comprehensive logistics and supply chain management strategy for the Prayagraj Maha Kumbh 2025, addressing the challenges posed by the massive influx of pilgrims. Special arrangements have been made for the devotees in Maha Kumbh. More than 35 thousand gas cylinders have been refilled, and 3500 new connections have also been issued. The work of refilling 5000 gas cylinders per day is being done in the fair. Food items are being provided primarily for the Akharas and Kalpvasis in the organisation of Maha Kumbh.

Establishment of Temporary Warehousing Facilities

Temporary warehouses had been set up at key locations within the Kumbh Mela area to store essential supplies, ensuring timely distribution and minimising transportation delays. To preserve perishable goods, the government had installed cold storage units, maintaining the quality of food supplies and medical provisions throughout the event.

Ration distribution by NAFED

A special scheme by the Union Government is providing quality ration at affordable prices for devotees during the Mahakumbh 2025 at Prayagraj. NAFED (National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India) is distributing wheat flour, pulses, rice, and other essential items at subsidised rates. Devotees can also order rations via WhatsApp or by calling. More than 1000 metric tons of rations have already been distributed, and the distribution is ongoing across the entire Mahakumbh city and Prayagraj through 20 mobile vans. To ensure that saints, kalpavasis and devotees at the Mahakumbh do not face any food shortages, ration delivery is being done via mobile vans.

महाकुंभ कहाँ-कहाँ मनाया जाता है?

प्रयागराज (उत्तर प्रदेश)

गंगा, यमुना और सरस्वती के संगम पर 12 वर्षों में एक बार महाकुंभ होता है।

हरिद्वार (उत्तराखंड)

गंगा नदी के तट पर 12 वर्षों में एक बार कुंभ होता है

उज्जैन (मध्य प्रदेश)

शिप्रा नदी के तट पर 12 वर्षों में एक बार सिंहस्थ कुंभ होता है।

नासिक (महाराष्ट्र)

गोदावरी नदी के तट पर 12 वर्षों में एक बार कुंभ होता है।

3.1 BRAND BORN OUT OF FAITH

The city of Prayagraj, formerly known as Allahabad, hosts the revered Hindu celebration of Kumbh Mela every twelve years, at the sacred confluence of the Ganga and Yamuna rivers. The Maha Kumbh Mela in 2025 was poised to be a momentous occasion, not only as a spiritual gathering but also as a significant business opportunity, with a staggering Rs 3,000 crore allocated solely for branding and marketing purposes. The Uttar Pradesh government's meticulous preparations were expected to attract an unprecedented 40 crore pilgrims, a substantial increase from the 25 crore attendees in 2019. And expectations were met.

The Mela ground area, spanning an impressive 4,000 hectares, witnessed a 20% expansion and was divided into 25 distinct sectors. The number of pucca ghats increased from four to nine, and the tent city doubled in size to accommodate approximately 1.6 lakh pilgrims' tents. Beyond its profound spiritual significance, the Maha Kumbh 2025 proved what one anticipated it to be -- a monumental economic event, presenting an unparalleled opportunity for marketers to engage with one of the world's largest audiences. The Kumbh Mela, in general, offers brands a unique chance to create lasting impressions, foster brand recognition, and encourage meaningful interactions with millions of devotees. According to projections by the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), the 2019 edition of the Kumbh had a profound economic impact of Rs 1.2 lakh crore, while the 2013 edition generated Rs 12,000 crore.

Brands at Maha Kumbh 2025

The Uttar Pradesh government invested heavily in the Mela in 2025, allocating nearly Rs 2,500 crore in the state budgets for 2024-2025 and 2023-2024. The Centre sanctioned a special grant of Rs 2,100 crore for the occasion. The Maha Kumbh Mela 2025 had a significant economic impact, and it was an attractive opportunity for businesses and a substantial boost to Uttar Pradesh's economy. Several business giants, including HUL, Coca-Cola, ITC, Bisleri, Parle, Dabur, Paytm, and Emami, made substantial investments in the event. To engage the vast gathering, these businesses launched branded lounges, virtual reality experiences, and interactive booths. With social media

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This campaign provided a personal experience with the product, enabling the brand to improve the overall Kumbh Mela experience for pilgrims. According to statistics of a study conducted, an impressive 6.7 million hands were cleaned, promoting hand-washing awareness and ensuring the safety of pilgrims.

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Dettol Banega Swasth India (DBSI) has been associated with the Kumbh Mela since 2016, providing critical interventions at various Melas, including the Varanasi, Nashik, and Ujjain Ardh Kumbh Melas and Magh Melas. To promote healthy habits, DBSI collaborated with the Akhadas to distribute millions of soaps to followers at food-serving locations. The campaign also aimed to support approximately 15,000 sanitation personnel by offering training courses and facilitating the availability of soap. With a focus on Kalpvasis, DBSI deployed health and hygiene volunteers across all 25 sectors of the Maha Kumbh.

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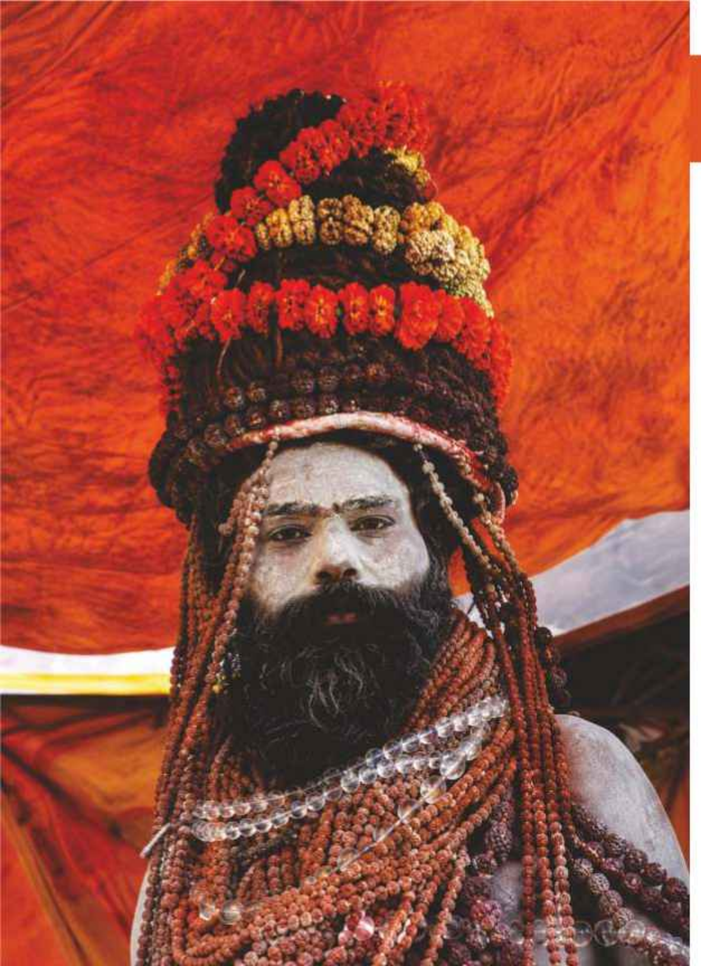


3.2 SPIRITUAL GATHERINGS, ECONOMIC OPPORTUNITIES

Introduction

Prayagraj geared up fully in the run-up to the 2025 Maha Kumbh Mela. Before the mela started, the expected turnout of pilgrims was pegged at 45 crore in the 45-day affair. However, an estimated 66 crore people streamed in during the period, surpassing all expectations. The government invested heavily in infrastructure, expanded the Mela grounds, and enhanced amenities. Businesses capitalised on the event, with over Rs. 3,000 crore allocated for economic impact. The Kumbh Mela, often regarded as the world's largest religious gathering, was not only a profound spiritual event but also an economic powerhouse.

Economic Impact and Revenue Generation

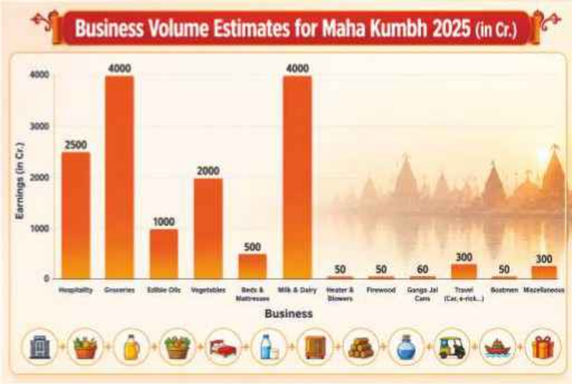
The financial footprint of the Kumbh Mela was immense. In 2013, the event generated approximately ₹12,000 crore in revenue. This figure surged to ₹1.2 lakh crore in 2019. For the 2025 Maha Kumbh Mela, projections estimated revenues could soar to ₹2 lakh crore. This was largely due to an anticipated attendance of about 66 crore people over the 45-day festival. Such massive revenue was driven by spending on transportation, accommodation, food, retail, and other services. For instance, during the 2019 Kumbh Mela, daily spending by visitors averaged ₹300-₹500 per person, contributing significantly to local businesses. For 2025, with inflation-adjusted expenses, this figure rose to ₹600-₹750 daily per person, magnifying its economic impact.

Hospitality Sector: Scaling New Heights

With over 400 million attendees expected, the hospitality industry transformed. From luxury hotels to budget accommodations, businesses innovated to cater to the diverse needs of visitors. The tourism and hospitality sectors stood to gain significantly from the influx of visitors. In 2019, over 24 crore visitors attended the event, generating approximately ₹1.2 lakh crore for these industries. The Kumbh Mela acted as a massive employment generator.

In 2013, the event created nearly 100,000 direct jobs and a similar number of indirect employment opportunities. By 2019, this number rose to over 600,000 jobs. For 2025, estimates suggested more than 800,000 jobs were created, covering sectors such as:

- **Tourism and Hospitality:** Over 300,000 individuals found work in hotels, guesthouses, and other lodging facilities.
- **Transport Services:** Approximately 150,000 people, including drivers, conductors, and logistics personnel, benefited from the increased demand for public and private transportation.
- **Retail and Food Vendors:** Over 200,000 vendors operated within the festival premises, offering food, beverages, and religious paraphernalia.
- **Event Management and Support Services:** Nearly 150,000 jobs emerged in event coordination, security, sanitation, and other supporting services.
- **Hotels and Lodges:** Nearly 60,000 accommodations, ranging from budget guesthouses to luxury hotels, operated at full capacity, collectively earning over ₹15,000 crore.
- **Temporary Shelters:** To accommodate the vast number of pilgrims, the government erected more than 100,000 tents, generating an additional ₹10,000 crore for the sector.
- **Food and Beverages:** Local eateries and food vendors earned upwards of ₹5,000 crore, catering to the diverse dietary preferences of attendees.
- **Tour Operators:** With millions of domestic and international tourists expected, tour operators earned an estimated ₹4,000 crore by offering curated travel packages, guided tours, and transport services.



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Infrastructure Development

Hosting an event of this magnitude required substantial investment in infrastructure. The Uttar Pradesh government allocated nearly

₹1 lakh per night for two guests, offering en-suite bathrooms, high-end services, and unparalleled river views. With demand peaking on auspicious bathing days, all 44 super-luxury tents at Sangam Nivas were sold out. The accommodation and hospitality sectors generated over ₹6,000 crore. With the Maha Kumbh festival less than two weeks away, electricity infrastructure worth Rs 400 crore has been put in place to ensure a 24-hour power supply for over 40 crore devotees. To this end, the Uttar Pradesh Power Corporation Ltd (UPPCL) has constructed 182 km of high-tension lines and 1,405 km of low-tension lines.

महाकुंभ कैसे मनाया जाता है?

पवित्र नदियों में स्नान

दान, पूजा और हवन

संतों के दर्शन और प्रवचन

सेवा, भंडारा और सहयोग

SECTION 4: A MELA MAJORLY PIVOTED ON TECHNOLOGY

4.1 WITNESSING A DIGITAL REBIRTH

Introduction

The Maha Kumbh 2025 in Prayagraj was poised to be an extraordinary fusion of the world's largest cultural and spiritual gathering, attracting millions of devotees not only from India but from around the globe. Although it was an ancient tradition, it promised and controlled a vast spiritual awakening, devotion, and cultural gathering. In the 21st century, IT and digital infrastructure plays a significant role in providing security and management to millions of devotees.

Various high technologies were deployed in the Maha Kumbh, including drone surveillance using AI, underwater drone systems, anti-drone systems called Drone Kawach, cyber security for modern Kumbh, multi-disaster response vehicles, IRS, and more.

This infrastructure imperatively solved challenges such as large-scale and complex gatherings, providing security and ease of spirituality for millions of pilgrims performing religious rituals, prayers, and holy bathing. The intelligence systems were actively deployed in Prayagraj city and neighbouring districts. Over 450 million pilgrims were expected to visit for holy baths and prayers in the Maha Kumbh 2025. Therefore, all pilgrims had to be informed about their security, hospitality, and, most importantly, health sector. To achieve this, the government deployed IT and digital platforms, deciding to disseminate information through social media platforms. Additionally, to prevent fake news, cyber experts actively destroyed online threats using advanced technologies. With this, an expert team discovered over 50 fake websites and took action against them. This chapter explains the survey on IT and digital transformation of the oldest tradition, highlighting how the 21st-century Maha Kumbh became modern and how IT and digital infrastructure worked tremendously with cutting-edge technologies. During this grand festival, millions of Sanatana people took holy baths in the Sangam, followed by every place in various holy rivers where the nectar was situated. To manage, secure, and monitor this massive event, IT and digital infrastructure were deployed in the Maha Kumbh 2025. These infrastructures plays a vital role in the digital transformation of the oldest tradition.

Technological evolution of Maha Kumbh:

This chapter also compares previous Maha Kumbh Melas with the current Maha Kumbh Mela 2025 in terms of IT and digital infrastructure. Initially, it was managed by local authorities manually under the guidance of different eras. Religious institutions plays a major role in accommodations and hospitality. Since there were no facilities for wireless communication or any kind of communication in the early Kumbh Mela, people hired messengers to transmit messages from one place to another inside the Kumbh Mela for security purposes.

In earlier Maha Kumbh Melas, crowds were managed by natural barriers to control the riverbank. After the kingdom rule, the colonial period began in India, i.e., British rule. They structured the crowd for monitoring in various sectors, especially in health. Counting of pilgrims was introduced, along with sanitation and bridge infrastructure development. After independence, the

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In Table 1, Statistics of IT and Digital Infrastructure used in Maha Kumbh 2025 are mentioned.

Security Measure	Details/Statistics
CCTV Cameras	2700 cameras with AI capabilities deployed for real-time monitoring
Facial Recognition Tech	Used at entry points for enhanced safety
Drones for Surveillance	Around 2000 drones deployed for aerial monitoring
Underwater Drones	Capable of diving up to 100 meters for round-the-clock surveillance
Fire Safety Budget	₹131.48 crore allocated for fire safety measures
Police Deployment	Over 50,000 personnel, including paramilitary forces
Anti Drone System	This drone system having 10 KM range to capture illegal drones
Cyber Security	Blockchain gives secure transaction during mela like ticketing, donations and other payment services.
Incident Response System (IRS):	Over 3000 life jackets and 100 diving kits or other cutting-edge technologies are used for IRS.
Robot Life Buoys	Over 440 robot life buoys used for instant emergency needs.
Digital Innovations	Wi-Fi zones, Mobile app & online services, integration with google maps are successfully deployed for pilgrims to ease and better connectivity.

This infrastructure imperatively solved challenges such as large-scale and complex gatherings, providing security and ease of spirituality for millions of pilgrims performing religious rituals, prayers, and holy bathing. The intelligence systems were actively deployed in Prayagraj city and neighbouring districts. Over 450 million pilgrims were expected to visit for holy baths and prayers in the Maha Kumbh 2025. Therefore, all pilgrims had to be informed about their security, hospitality, and, most importantly, health sector. To achieve this, the government deployed IT and digital platforms, deciding to disseminate information through social media platforms. Additionally, to prevent fake news, cyber experts actively destroyed online threats using advanced technologies. With this, an expert team discovered over 50 fake websites and took action against them. This chapter explains the survey on IT and digital transformation of the oldest tradition, highlighting how the 21st-century Maha Kumbh became modern and how IT and digital infrastructure worked tremendously with cutting-edge technologies. During this grand festival, millions of Sanatana people took holy baths in the Sangam, followed by every place in various holy rivers where the nectar was situated. To manage, secure, and monitor this massive event, IT and digital infrastructure were deployed in the Maha Kumbh

महाकुंभ की विशेषताएँ

- करोड़ों श्रद्धालु स्नान करते हैं।
- साधु-संतों के अखाड़ों की शोभायात्रा (शाही स्नान) प्रमुख आकर्षण होती है।
- यह धार्मिक, सामाजिक और सांस्कृतिक एकता का संगम है।
- यहाँ ज्ञान, ध्यान, योग, सत्संग और सेवा के अनेक कार्यक्रम होते हैं।
- देश-विदेश से लोग आकर भारतीय संस्कृति की दिव्यता का अनुभव करते हैं।

SECTION 5: UNMATCHED MASS FACILITIES

5.1 KUMBH ON THE MOVE: ENHANCED TRANSPORTATION

Introduction

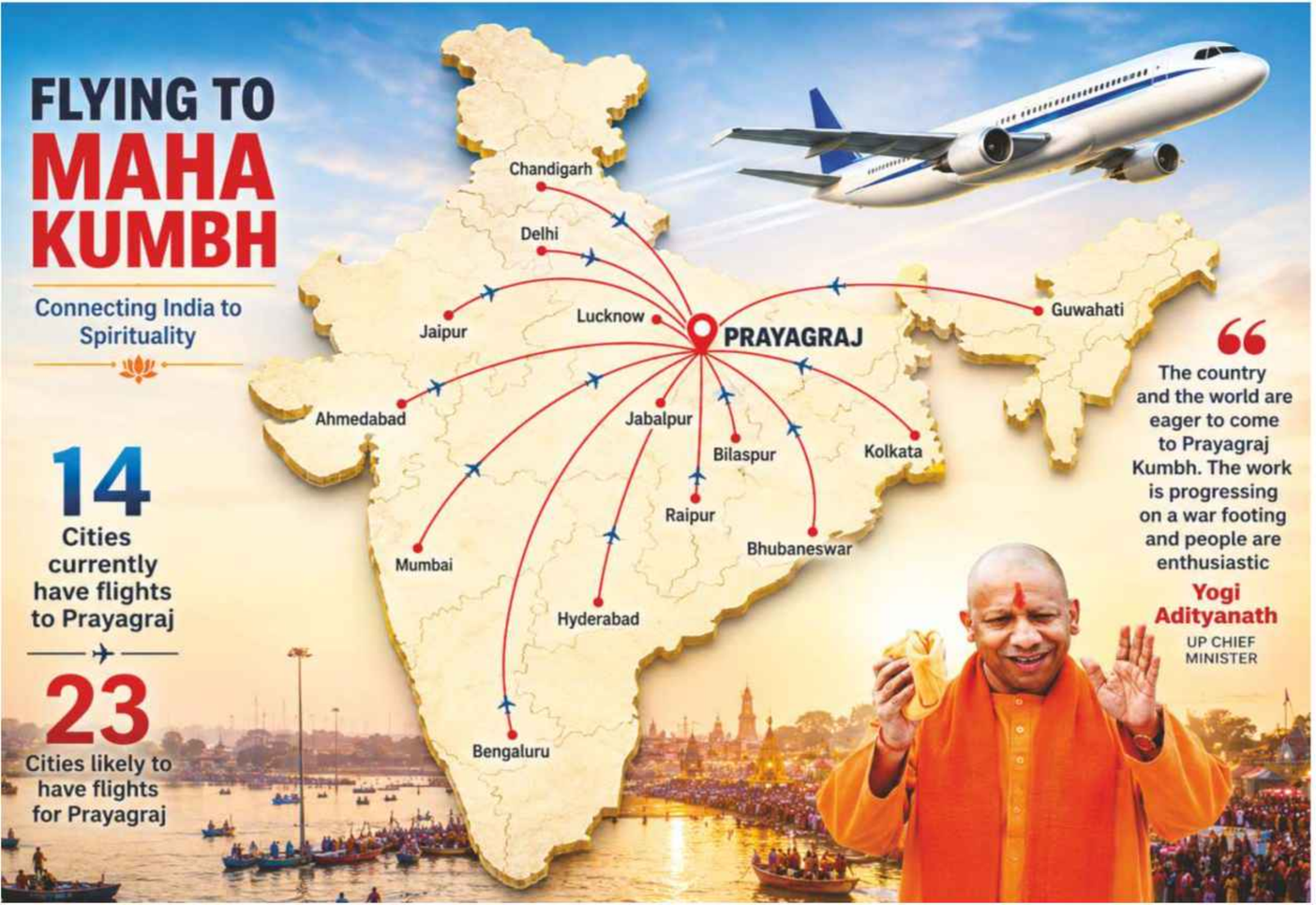
The Maha Kumbh 2025 witnessed a monumental leap in transportation facilities, underscoring the nation's unwavering commitment to seamless logistics and infrastructure development. The freight train operations during this grand event saw a remarkable twofold increase compared to the 2013 and 2019 Kumbh Melas, reflecting an unprecedented surge in activity. This remarkable escalation in freight train operations demonstrates India's rapid progress in modernizing its transportation infrastructure, catering to the burgeoning needs of its vast population. An official statement highlighted that with the culmination of the Maha Kumbh 2025, the Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC) Network achieved a landmark milestone in freight train operations. The Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India (DFCCIL) efficiently managed an average of 391 trains per day on DFC tracks, with the Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor (EDFC) handling 209 trains daily and the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (WDFC) operating 182 trains per day. In the 2013 Kumbh, an average of 72.62 freight trains ran daily, which rose to 78.21 per day during the 2019 event. However, during the Maha Kumbh 2025, the Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor (EDFC) significantly boosted its operations, handling an average of 149.45 freight trains per day between January 11 and February 26, the key 'Snan' (bath) period. DFCCIL's impressive feat of managing a substantial number of trains on a daily basis underscores its unwavering commitment to ensuring the smooth execution of logistics operations during the Maha Kumbh, 2025. Beyond its role in managing freight operations, DFCCIL also organised an exhibition camp in Prayagraj, attracting large numbers of devotees and visitors.

Preparations and Infrastructure

Prayagraj, the host city of the Maha Kumbh 2025, underwent extensive preparations to ensure a seamless and enriching experience for the millions of devotees and visitors. Some of the notable initiatives included:

- **Luxury Accommodations:** The Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) established a 'Premium Tent City' named 'Maha Kumbh Gram', offering luxurious lodging facilities to visitors. The tent city boasted exclusive luxury accommodations, replete with state-of-the-art infrastructure, catering to the diverse needs of the discerning travellers. IRCTC's initiative to provide luxurious accommodations underscores the government's efforts to promote tourism and provide world-class facilities to visitors.

- **Safety Measures:** To ensure the safety and security of the devotees, additional security measures were implemented, including AI-assisted surveillance systems. Furthermore, nearly 1.5 lakh sanitation facilities were put in place to maintain cleanliness during the event. The implementation of AI-assisted surveillance systems demonstrates the government's commitment to leveraging cutting-edge technology to ensure the safety and security of citizens.
- **Cultural Activities:** A Bird Festival was scheduled during the Mahakumbh to raise awareness about conservation



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- **Satellite Parking:** The Mela police set up 20 satellite parking lots to manage vehicular movement and ensure the convenience of devotees. These satellite parking lots offered facilities like cloakrooms, a 'rain basera' (night shelter), a crane facility, a first-aid post, police assistance booths, and shops for essential commodities.

- **Cranes:** Mela police deployed at least 60 big and small cranes at parking lots to clear the routes, including highways connecting Prayagraj with seven neighbouring districts/states. The cranes were deployed based on the size of the parking lots.

- **Traffic Plan:** The Mela traffic police drafted a separate plan for Parade, Jhunsi, and Arail, as the entire mela area was divided into 25 sectors. The Mela police also installed 1,700 signages for the benefit of visitors, and over 500 shuttle

buses were deployed during the grand event. A total of 195 watch-cum guidance towers were put up in and around the mela area.

Traffic Management Plan for Maha Kumbh 2025

The 2025 Maha Kumbh Mela in Prayagraj witnessed a massive influx of devotees, and to ensure their safe and smooth movement, the Mela police devised an elaborate traffic management plan. The plan was designed to streamline the movement of devotees on both normal and 'snan' days, ensuring a hassle-free experience for the millions of pilgrims visiting the sacred city.

- **No-Vehicle Zone:** A 'no vehicle zone' plan was implemented, restricting vehicular movement on streets leading to Sangam and routes from parking sites to Sangam. This plan was enforced for three days on five main 'snan' days: Paush Purnima, Makar Sankranti, Basant Panchami, Maghi Purnima, and Mahashivratri. On Mauni Amavasya, the 'no vehicle zone' was implemented for four days – two days before Mauni Amavasya, on the main 'snan' day, and a day succeeding it.
- **Routes and Parking:** Devotees were directed to follow Kali Sadak to move towards Sangam and return through Triveni Marg. A green corridor was set up on Naval Rai Marg, while Lal Sadak was reserved for administrative purposes. Separate entry and exit routes were designated for normal and main 'snan' days, with distinct routes and parking lots for passengers arriving by bus, train, and private vehicles. The Mela police authorities focused on inter-state/inter-district coordination for vehicular movement, working closely with the Government Railway Police (GRP), railways, roadways, and district police to regulate the flow

of devotees and avoid chaotic situations.

Devotees will follow Kali Sadak to move towards Sangam and return through Triveni Marg. Mela police authorities have also set up a green corridor on Naval Rai Marg. Lal Sadak would be reserved for administrative purposes. Routes for holding areas and shuttle buses have been finalised, and an emergency plan is also in place.

Separate entry and exit routes

After dividing the entire mela area into three super zones Parade (City), Jhunsi and Arail – the police have earmarked separate entry and exit routes for normal and main 'snan' days. There will be separate entry and exit routes as well as parking lots for passengers coming by bus, train, and private vehicles. Mela police will offer priority to pedestrians moving towards Sangam from seven different parts of the district. There are 84 holding areas 45 in the city, 18 in trans-Ganga, and 21 in trans-Yamuna.

Traffic plan on pontoon bridges

Mela police authorities have also drafted a traffic movement plan on 28 pontoon bridges. Out of these, 23 will connect Parade (City) and Jhunsi, while five pontoon bridges will connect Arail and Jhunsi. The Mela police authorities have focused on interstate/inter-district coordination for vehicular movement along with GRP, railways, roadways and district police to regulate flow of devotees to avoid chaotic situations. The Uttar Pradesh government made a variety of transportation arrangements for the 2025 Maha Kumbh Mela in Prayagraj, including buses, trains, and shuttle buses.

Public Transportation

The Uttar Pradesh government arranged for an extensive network of public transportation, including:

- **Bus Services:** 19 buses ferried devotees to Kumbh, while 7,550 buses operated from all 75 districts of the state to Prayagraj. Temporary bus stations were set up, and buses ran every 10 minutes at four temporary bus stations. The UP-State Road Transport Corporation (UPSRTC) planned to keep at least 7,000 buses ready for Kumbh Mela, with buses operating for Maha Kumbh being colour-coded in saffron for clarity to passengers. These buses operated from different regions specifically for Maha Kumbh. Considering the state government's desire to make the event environment-friendly, only buses with improved emission norms like BSVI and BSIV plied for Maha Kumbh from all 20 regions of the corporation.

5.2 ENGINEERING EXCELLENCE ENSURES SEAMLESS FACILITIES

Introduction

The Maha Kumbh Mela, often celebrated as the most extensive human congregation globally, embodied the intersection of belief, cultural heritage, and engineering ingenuity. The 2025 event, which took place in Prayagraj (previously known as Allahabad), India, attracted more than 450 million devotees over 55 days. The immense scale of this occasion posed extraordinary challenges regarding infrastructure, crowd control, sanitation, and ecological sustainability. This chapter explores the engineering feats that supported the preparation and implementation of the Maha Kumbh 2025, focusing on the groundbreaking strategies adopted to provide a smooth and secure experience for millions of worshippers.

Historical Significance and Scale of Maha Kumbh 2025

- The 2025 Maha Kumbh marked a 144-year cycle, making it historically significant.
- An estimated 450 million visitors attended over 60 days, requiring meticulous urban planning.
- Key bathing dates saw 50-100 million devotees daily.

Comparison with previous Kumbh Melas:

- ***2013 Maha Kumbh:*** 120 million attendees.
- ***2019 Ardh Kumbh:*** 240 million attendees.

The Scale of the Challenge

The Maha Kumbh Mela was more than merely a religious event; it presented a massive logistical and engineering challenge. Organising the event entailed constructing a temporary city capable of housing millions, equipped with accommodation, sanitation, healthcare, transportation, and communication services. The

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MahaKhumbh Arail Ghat Prayagraj

Ghat Prayagraj

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Key Challenges:

1. ***Crowd Management:*** Ensuring the safe movement of millions of people in a confined space.
2. ***Sanitation and Waste Management:*** Providing adequate sanitation facilities and managing waste generated by millions of pilgrims.
3. ***Water Supply and Management:*** Ensuring a continuous supply of clean water for drinking, bathing, and sanitation.
4. ***Healthcare and Emergency Services:*** Setting up temporary hospitals and emergency response systems to handle medical emergencies.
5. ***Environmental Sustainability:*** Minimising the environmental impact of the event and ensuring sustainable practices.
6. ***Communication and Connectivity:*** Providing reliable communication networks for both pilgrims and organisers.

Engineering Solutions: A Case Study of the 2025 Maha Kumbh

1. Temporary Infrastructure: *The Floating Pontoon Bridges & Land Reclamation*

One of the most iconic engineering feats of the Maha Kumbh was the construction of temporary pontoon bridges across the Ganges and Yamuna rivers and reclaiming the land from the Ganga through riverbank dredging. These bridges were essential for the safe movement of pilgrims to and from the main bathing ghats

Pontoon Bridges

(riverbanks).

Some facts highlighting the work related to infrastructure, land reclamation and expansion:

- 26 hectares of additional land were reclaimed through riverbank dredging.
- Over 450 km of roads were constructed for seamless connectivity.
- A temporary city spanning 4,000 hectares was divided into 25 sectors.

Bridges and Flyovers

- 7 new pontoon bridges were constructed over the Ganges.
- Permanent flyovers were built at key entry points to reduce

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Smart Bio Toilet Equipped with Sensor

Sanitation Work Every Time

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Control Centre

Central HealthCare Facility

Instant ICU unit for Mahakumbh

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6. Case Studies of Past Maha Kumbh Events vs. 2025 Innovations

Event	Infrastructure	Sanitation	Technology	Crowd Management
2013 Maha Kumbh	Basic road expansions	Manual cleaning	Minimal AI usage	Manual monitoring
2019 Ardh Kumbh	Semi-digital infrastructure	Some bio-toilets	Limited AI and drone	Basic crowd control tech
2025 Maha Kumbh	Smart city-level planning	AI-monitored sanitation	Fully digital AI-based experience	predictive crowd control

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5.3 AI & DATA SCIENCE GUARANTEE DEVOTEE SAFETY

Introduction

The Maha Kumbh, one of the world's largest religious gatherings, drew millions of devotees from across India and globally. In the digital era, managing such a massive event, which occurs once every 114 years, necessitated the use of advanced technology. Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Data Science play a pivotal role in ensuring seamless, efficient, and controllable operations during the Maha Kumbh.

The 2025 Maha Kumbh in Prayagraj was anticipated to be the world's largest cultural and spiritual gathering, and over 66 crore devotees participated. The Uttar Pradesh government spared no effort in ensuring the event's safety, security, and memorability. To guarantee the safety of devotees, security arrangements and management were tightened at temples and major sites within the Maha Kumbh Nagar. An Artificial Intelligence system was activated in the Maha Kumbh Mela area, Prayagraj, and the surrounding districts. Multiple checkpoints were established to screen every person entering the district. Intelligence squads were deployed to monitor suspicious activities and maintain vigilance throughout the area.

Committed to making the Kumbh Mela the biggest spiritual event in Sanatan Dharma, the Uttar Pradesh government prepared an AI and Data Science role-based comprehensive plan to deal with any emergency and overall management of the mela. The Uttar Pradesh government partnered with private tech firms and academic institutions to deploy AI-powered surveillance systems for crowd density estimation, behaviour analysis, and alert systems in high-risk zones. Through IoT-enabled devices and GPS tracking, officials could monitor real-time crowd movements and create predictive models to anticipate potential overcrowding, enhancing safety for all attendees.

Creative of Maha Kumbh

To keep pilgrims informed and ensure a smooth experience, authorities introduced a dedicated Kumbh Mela 2025 mobile app. The app offered navigation assistance, emergency contact information, and live updates on rituals and events. Additionally, the app featured a 'Lost & Found' section and enabled users to book accommodations or access medical support with a few taps. Over 1.5 million people were projected to use this app, as it catered to both local and international pilgrims with multilingual options, covering languages such as Hindi, English, and Bengali.

Crowd Management and Monitoring

One of the significant challenges in the Maha Kumbh was managing large crowds. AI-powered cameras and drones were utilised to monitor crowd movement in real-time. These cameras analysed video feeds using computer vision techniques to detect overcrowding and alert authorities before any situation became critical. AI models also predicted peak hours and suggested alternate routes to control congestion. ANPR and AI-enabled cameras were used by the police and local administration to monitor the

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Bhashini App

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Traffic Management

The Maha Kumbh 2025 saw the implementation of AI-driven traffic management systems. Smart traffic lights adjusted their signals based on real-time traffic data, reducing congestion and ensuring smooth vehicle flow. GPS-based AI applications guided travellers with the best routes and updated them about road closures and alternative paths. Large-scale deployment of remote-controlled life belts was initiated to enhance safe

Health and Medical Assistance

A large gathering poses health risks, including the spread of diseases. AI-powered health monitoring systems were installed to check body temperatures and detect potential health threats. Chatbots and virtual assistants provided medical guidance and

5.4 INTERIOR DESIGN EXPERIENCES DURING MAHAKUMBH

Introduction

Millions of pilgrim's flock to the Maha Kumbh Mela, one of the biggest religious events in the world, in search of spiritual renewal and social camaraderie. Although the event's significance has been extensively researched, little is known about how interior design in communal and spiritual settings influences the pilgrims' emotional and psychological experiences. This chapter explores the ways in which pilgrims' experiences at the Mahakumbh are impacted by interior design features like layout, colour, lighting, and symbolic décor. Observation studies and interviews help researchers to figure out how design elements relate to pilgrims' spiritual and emotional results.

India is home to numerous architectural wonders and holy pilgrimage sites, and the country is rich in ancient customs and vibrant cultures. By fusing architectural exploration with spiritual enlightenment, these locations provide a singular chance to explore the core of Indian spirituality. With millions of pilgrims and tourists drawn to these richly diverse pilgrimage sites and their historical landmarks each year, architectural tourism in India is a thriving industry and a vital component of cross-cultural interaction.

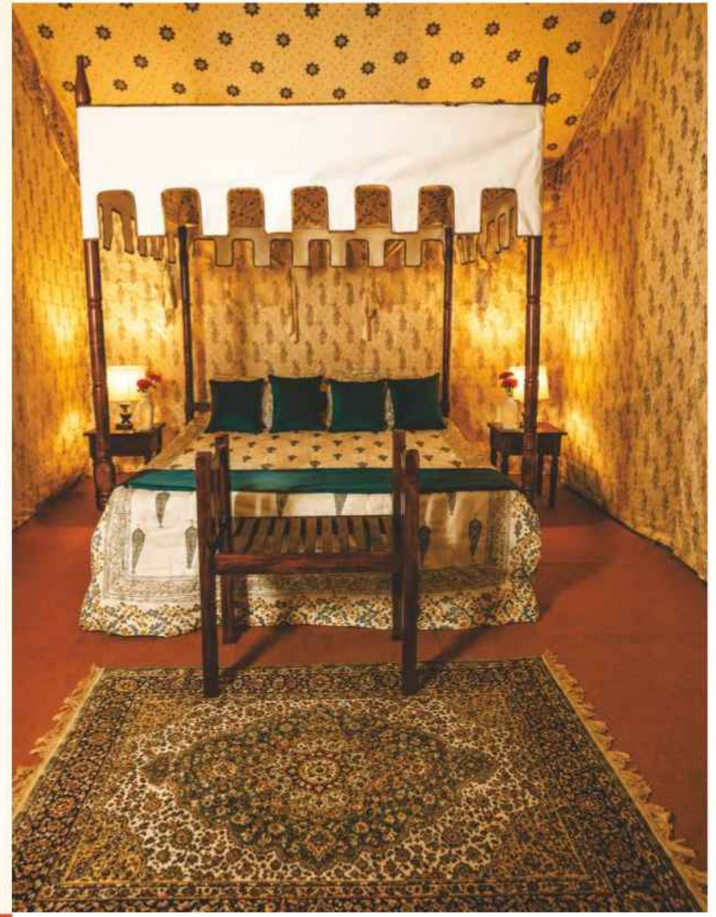
Design features

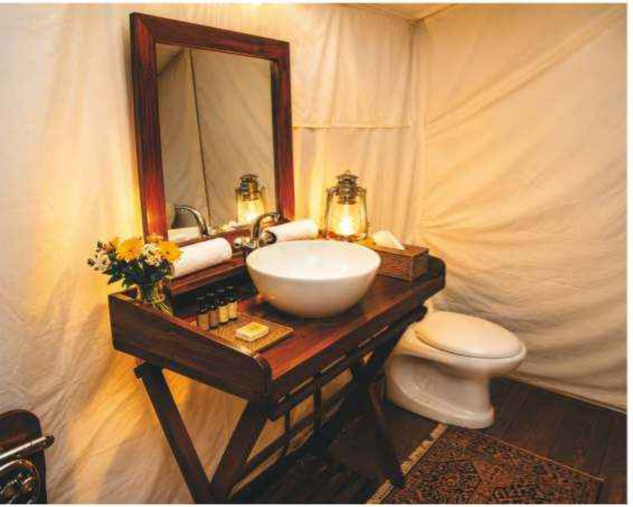
Every twelve years, India hosts the Mahakumbh Mela, a festival that attracts millions of visitors who come to carry out rituals, obtain blessings, and achieve spiritual purification. An important factor in improving the participants' overall experience is the interior design of places like temples, communal tents, and public gathering places. The purpose of this study is to investigate this relationship and comprehend how pilgrims' experiences can be improved or worsened by careful design.

The amount of research that is currently available emphasizes how crucial the environment is in influencing human experiences. According to research in environmental psychology, design features have a big impact on social interactions, stress levels, and mood. Additionally, studies on sacred spaces show that elements like communal layouts, symbolism, and light have an impact on spiritual experiences. There are, however, few studies that explicitly address pilgrim experiences during major gatherings like the Mahakumbh.

Design Elements

During the Mahakumbh, different communal and spiritual areas were observed ethnographically in order to examine the relationships between pilgrim behaviour and design features. Researchers worked with pilgrims, architects, interior designers, and event planners to learn more about how people view design





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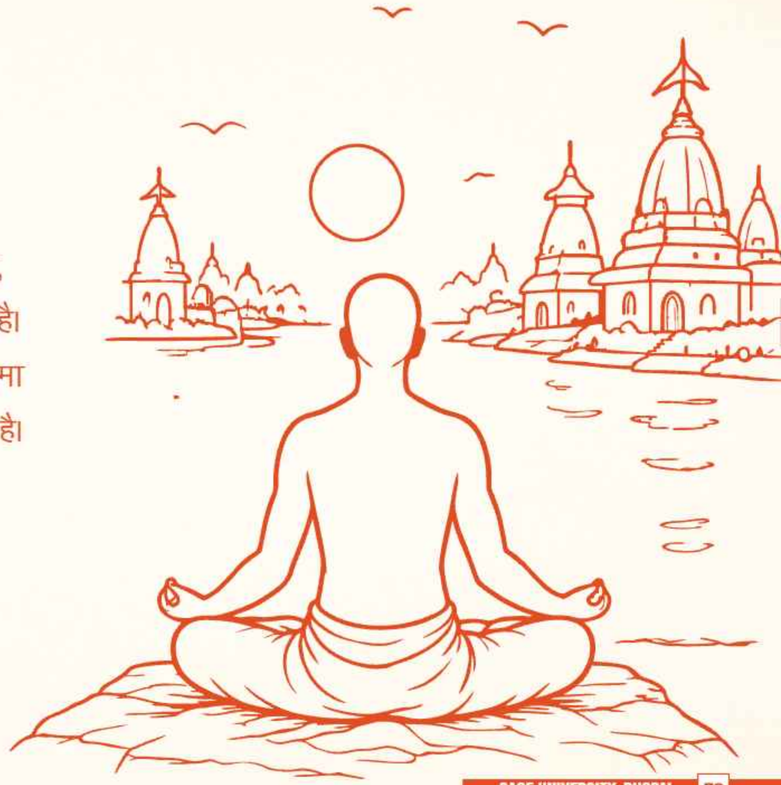
महाकुंभ का संदेश

महाकुंभ हमें हमारी संस्कृति, आस्था, एकता और मानवता का पाठ पढ़ाता है। यह केवल एक मेला नहीं, बल्कि आत्मा को परमात्मा से जोड़ने का महासंगम है।



A WATCHFUL EYE ON HEALTH & ENVIRONMENTAL SAFETY

SECTION 6:

6.1 HEALTH, HYGIENE AND ECO MOVE HAND-IN-HAND

Introduction

A journey to the Kumbh Mela 2025 is a deeply immersive experience, marked by the overwhelming sight of millions of devotees gathered at the confluence of the Ganges, Yamuna, and Saraswati rivers, where one can witness vibrant cultural displays, the unique traditions of Naga Sadhus, and a profound sense of spiritual connection, all while participating in the sacred ritual of taking a holy dip in the river, considered to cleanse sins and bring spiritual liberation; it's a once-in-a-lifetime event that offers a blend of cultural grandeur, religious devotion, and a chance to witness the rich heritage of India firsthand. A mix of rituals, spiritual practices, and cultural activities during Kumbh Mela 2025 defined the grandeur of this event. Some of the best activities and rituals that one saw included:

Holy Dips or Shahi Snan: The ultimate attraction to the Kumbh Mela was the royal bath by saints and devotees in the sacred waters of the Triveni Sangam. The ritual was meant to cleanse the soul from all evil and sins. The Kumbh Mela dates for bathing had special importance, with the most auspicious ones attracting millions of devotees.

Devotional Singing and Satsang: Devotional songs and spiritual discourses formed an essential part of Kumbh. The

pilgrims sat together to listen to the wisdom of the spiritual leader and enhance their connection to the divine.

Ganga Aarti: In the evenings, the Ganga ghats came alive in grandeur with aarti. Priests lighting the lamps and singing the bhajans as an ode to the river were a sight to behold. The location for the Kumbh Mela 2025 date and place, Prayagraj, presented one of the most colourful experiences of Aarti.

Cultural Attractions: The Kumbh Mela, with all its rituals, also carried cultural performances and folk dances to create a spectacular fair based on the rich traditions of India. It was an experience through which one could feel the cultural and social importance of Kumbh Mela in a lively and joyful environment.

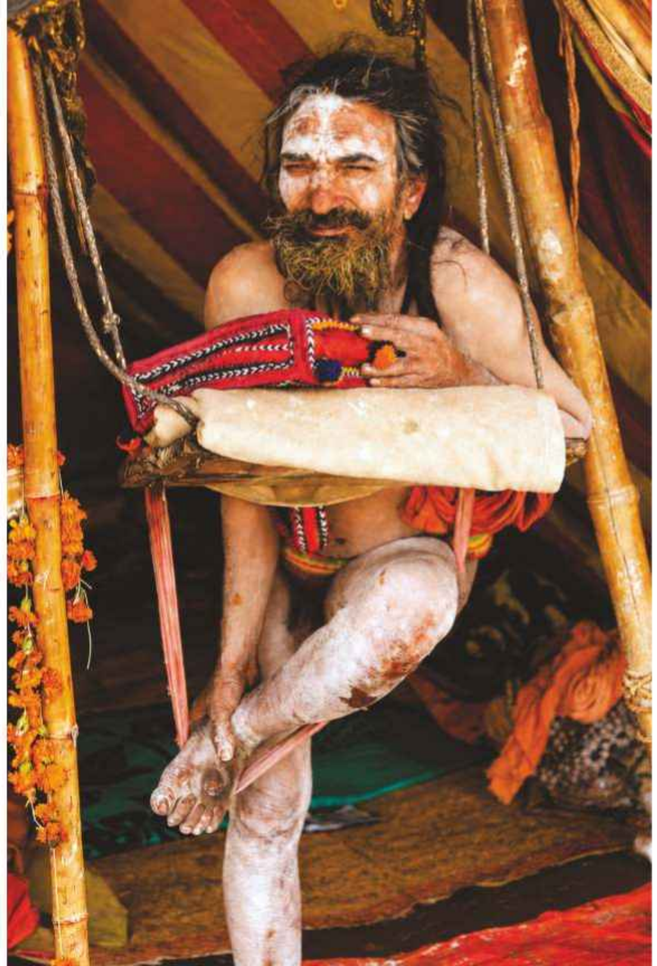
Health Care in Prayagraj Maha Kumbh 2025

To ensure the proper health and well-being of the pilgrims and the tourists, especially women and children attending the mega religious fair of Maha Kumbh 2025, the state government had appointed over 400 doctors and more than 700 paramedical staff in the mela. This medical team provided round-the-clock services, with many beds reserved for women and children. Additionally, gynaecologists and paediatricians were also deployed in shifts to address their health needs.

Given the large expected turnout of women devotees, special health facilities were arranged. Women doctors served in three shifts in the fair's hospitals, and gynaecologists were available around the clock. A labour room was set up in the Central Hospital, supported by specialist doctors, and 11 successful deliveries were conducted in the Kumbh Mela hospital. Furthermore, emergency services were available 24 hours a day at the Community Health Centre and Primary Health Centre. Adequate provisions for additional medicines, dressings, and other essentials were made. A temporary central hospital was set up in the Mela area, with beds allocated for women and children.

AYUSH at Maha Kumbh

The Ayush OPDs, clinics, stalls, and wellness sessions emerged as major attractions for devotees and visitors at Maha Kumbh 2025, Prayagraj. The Ministry of Ayush, in collaboration with the National Ayush Mission, Uttar Pradesh, provided free healthcare services to both domestic and international pilgrims. With a strong



focus on traditional healing systems, Ayush services received widespread participation, reinforcing the global trust in Ayurveda, Homoeopathy, and Naturopathy.

Key Highlights of Ayush Services:

- **Extensive Healthcare Support:** Over 1.21 lakh devotees availed Ayush services during the festival.
- **Dedicated Ayush OPDs:** A team of 80 doctors across 20 OPDs provided 24x7 medical services, addressing both common and chronic conditions.
- **International Participation:** Foreign devotees also accessed Ayush OPD consultations and wellness therapies.
- **Yoga Therapy Sessions:** Daily therapeutic yoga sessions were conducted from 8:00 AM to 9:00 AM at designated camps in the Sangam area and Sector-8, led by experts from the Morarji Desai National Institute of Yoga (MDNIY), New Delhi.

Integrated Healthcare: Over 7 lakh pilgrims received medical care, including: 4.5 lakh treated at 23 allopathic hospitals. 3.71 lakh pathology tests conducted. Around 3,800 minor and 12 major surgeries were successfully performed

Specialist Involvement: Experts from AIIMS Delhi, IMS BHU, and international specialists from Canada, Germany, and Russia contributed to providing world-class healthcare.

Traditional Treatments: 20 AYUSH hospitals offered treatments in Ayurveda, Homoeopathy, and Naturopathy to over 2.18 lakh pilgrims.

Holistic Wellness: Services such as Panchakarma, yoga therapy, and health awareness campaigns were well-received, enhancing the overall well-being of attendees.

Cleanliness and Hygiene

The 2025 Kumbh Mela was kept clean and hygienic through a combination of sanitation workers, trash skimmer machines, and sewage treatment plants.

- Sanitation workers and private and government vendors cleaned the mela area and toilets.
- Sanitation workers worked around the clock to keep the area clean.
- Ganga Seva Doots (volunteers) removed flowers and other materials from the river.
- Trash skimmer machines collected waste like flowers, coconuts, clothes, and plastic from the Sangam and collected over 10-15 tonnes of waste daily.
- Sewage treatment plants treated the large sewage, with 11 permanent sewage treatment plants and three temporary ones.
- Bangalore University developed modified advanced oxidation technology for toilet sanitation.
- More than 200 automatic dispensing machines provided clean drinking water.

Other initiatives

Special machinery scoops out pooja materials and other things dumped by devotees in the river. Green Mahakumbh includes discussions on issues related to nature, the environment, water, and cleanliness.

Conclusion

The conclusion of the Kumbh Mela marked the culmination of one of the world's largest spiritual gatherings, symbolising purification, renewal, and the collective journey toward salvation. The Kumbh Mela concluded with a spiritual high, leaving millions of devotees rejuvenated and inspired. The event not only fulfilled individual aspirations for salvation but also reinforced collective faith, ensuring the continuation of this grand tradition for future generations.

6.2 BE SURE, YOUR HEALTH'S IN SAFE HANDS

Introduction

The 2025 Maha Kumbh Mela was observed over 45 days, with the day of Amavasya attracting the largest number on a single day. According to official figures, the largest one-day attendance at the Kumbh Mela was 30 million on 10 February 2013 and 50 million on 4 February 2019. In 1882, the Maha Kumbh Mela was significant, as it was one of the first major gatherings of Hindus after the Indian Rebellion of 1857. The event helped to revitalise Hinduism and promote unity among Hindus. The 1882 Maha Kumbh Mela had a lasting impact on the city of Allahabad and the Hindu community as a whole.

Crowding and Public Health Challenges

Speaking of the huge congregation of pilgrims, it is obvious that crowding is a big issue to deal with. Crowding in residential areas has become a pressing issue in urban planning and public health. As the global population continues to grow and urbanise, cities are facing unprecedented challenges in providing adequate housing, infrastructure, and services to their residents. Crowding services not only affect the quality of life of residents but also have far-reaching consequences for their physical and mental health, social relationships, and economic well-being. In the wake of the winter flu season, the holding of mass gatherings like the Kumbh Mela posed health risks. Many experts urged people to avoid crowded places to mitigate virus spread. India was on alert over the spread of the human metapneumovirus or HMPV, and the rapid spread of the virus and influenza raised alarms globally.

Health Risks and Challenges at Mass Gatherings

A study published in the Journal of Travel Medicine in May, 2024 indicated that "acute respiratory infections, fever, skin disorders, diarrhoea, and other infectious diseases like influenza, gastroenteritis, chickenpox, hepatitis, etc., could spread more easily during the Kumbh Mela because of the numerous religious events, cramped living quarters, and solid and liquid waste produced throughout the event."

The earliest documented record of infectious disease at the Kumbh Mela festival was an outbreak of cholera in 1817. There were sporadic epidemics during the Kumbh Mela in 1892, 1948, and in the 1960s, according to the report published in the "International Journal of Infectious Diseases." The "Comprehensive Review of the Kumbh Mela" epidemic report suggested the interplay of three factors that led to cholera epidemics during

1. Fouling of river waters by the exceptionally large proportion of bathers to the quantity of water available.
2. The growth of Vibrio cholerae was assisted by the unusually hot weather at the site.
3. Increased virulence of the bacteria elsewhere in India.

Consequences of Maha Kumbh Mela 2025

The Mahakumbh Mela 2025 in India led to several consequences, including:

- **Public Health Issues:** The proximity of large crowds facilitated the rapid spread of communicable diseases like diarrhoea, respiratory infections, and skin infections due to

poor hygiene and contaminated water from the river where mass bathing occurred.

- **Disease Transmission:** The mass gathering resulted in an increased risk of disease transmission among pilgrims.
- **Waterborne Diseases:** Increased bacterial load in the river water due to human waste could have led to outbreaks of waterborne illnesses like cholera.
- **Strain on Healthcare Infrastructure:** The sudden influx of pilgrims overwhelmed local healthcare facilities.
- **Waste Generation:** The massive crowd produced large amounts of plastic and other non-biodegradable waste, polluting the river and surrounding areas.
- **Water Pollution:** Ritualistic activities like idol immersion further contaminated the river water.
- **Impact on Local Ecosystems:** The increased human activity disrupted the natural balance of the river ecosystem.
- **Crowd Crush Incidents:** Overcrowding led to stampedes, causing injuries and fatalities and leading to psychological trauma among survivors and witnesses.
- **Stress and Anxiety:** The intense environment with large crowds and physical exertion triggered stress and anxiety in some pilgrims.

Overcoming Barriers to Healthcare Delivery in Mahakumbh 2025

Infrastructure Barriers

1. ***Limited medical facilities:*** Insufficient medical facilities, including hospitals and clinics, catered to the massive influx of pilgrims during Mahakumbh 2025.
2. ***Inadequate sanitation:*** Poor sanitation and hygiene conditions increased the risk of waterborne and infectious diseases.
3. ***Crowding and congestion:*** Overcrowding and congestion at medical facilities made it challenging for medical staff to provide timely and effective care.

Human Resource Barriers

1. Shortage of medical staff: An insufficient number of medical professionals, including doctors, nurses, and paramedics, were available to handle the massive demand.
2. **Limited training and capacity:** Medical staff lacked the necessary training and capacity to handle complex medical cases and emergencies.
3. **Language barriers:** Communication challenges arose due to language barriers between medical staff and pilgrims from diverse linguistic backgrounds.

Technological Barriers

1. **Limited telemedicine facilities:** Insufficient telemedicine facilities were available to provide remote medical consultations and monitoring.
2. **Poor internet connectivity:** Limited internet connectivity and network coverage hindered communication and data transmission.
3. **Inadequate electronic health records:** Limited use of electronic health records made it challenging to maintain accurate and up-to-date medical records.

Logistical Barriers

1. **Transportation challenges:** Difficulty in transporting patients to medical facilities arose due to congestion and limited transportation options.
2. Supply chain disruptions: Disruptions in medical supply chains led to shortages of essential medicines and equipment.
3. Waste management: Inadequate waste management systems increased the risk of environmental pollution and health hazards.

Financial Barriers

1. Limited budget allocation: Insufficient budget allocation for healthcare services led to limited resources and infrastructure.
2. Out-of-pocket expenses: High out-of-pocket expenses for pilgrims made healthcare inaccessible to many.
3. Limited insurance coverage: Limited insurance coverage for pilgrims left them vulnerable to financial shocks due to medical emergencies.

Health Concerns During Mahakumbh 2025

During Mahakumbh 2025, open-air defecation remained a problem, and tons of decaying marigolds, coconuts, and other gifts accumulated on the river's surface as worshipers sipped the sacred water. These actions produced a variety of enteric illnesses. A study by the Harvard School of Public Health observed 30,000 patients at four sector hospitals and found a 5% prevalence of diarrheal illnesses over 23 days. The shaving procedure that thousands of would-be sadhus underwent for initiation posed another possible health danger. Although hepatitis B can be prevented by immunization, blood-borne illness transmission was possible during this ceremony.

Conclusion

The Kumbh Mela presented challenging public health issues during Mahakumbh 2025. Reducing possible risk factors was crucial, and medical professionals and public health officials were aware of the common health hazards associated with the pilgrimage. Large crowds pose significant health issues, particularly for disease control. Comprehending the Kumbh Mela can offer important insights for handling large crowds. Future in-depth research on the Kumbh Mela is necessary to produce proof for context-specific interventions to address the intricate health issues associated with large crowds.

6.3 SAFE DRINKING WATER SET AS TOP PRIORITY

Introduction

The Ganga and Yamuna Rivers in Prayagraj faced significant strain during the 2025 Maha Kumbh, one of the world's largest religious events. Concerns over environmental and public health risks grew as millions of devotees took baths in the rivers. A report submitted by the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) to the National Green Tribunal (NGT) highlighted alarming levels of contamination, primarily due to untreated sewage discharge and extensive human activity.

Water Quality Findings

- On January 14, 2025, the Sangam Ghat recorded approximately 11,000 units of faecal coliform, exceeding the allowable limit of 2,500 units by more than four times.
- According to the CPCB report presented to the NGT on February 3, 2025, the water quality on January 12-13, 2025, was deemed unfit for drinking and bathing.
- Freshwater intrusion upstream was noted to have reduced organic pollution.

Key Water Quality Indicators

Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD): On January 13, 2025, the BOD level at Sangam was 3.94 milligrams per litre, with levels exceeding maximum allowable limits on certain days, such as Paush Purnima.

Faecal Coliform Levels as measured:

- 11,000 MPN/100 ml on January 14 (Makar Sankranti), exceeding allowable limits by more than four times.
- 49,000 MPN/100 ml on January 20, exceeding allowable limits by more than 19 times.
- 13,000 MPN/100 ml on January 15 and 30 near Nagvasuki Mandir on the Ganga, exceeding allowable limits by more than five times.
- 11,000 MPN/100 ml on February 4, exceeding allowable limits by more than four times.
- The water quality during the 2025 Maha Kumbh posed significant public health risks due to high levels of faecal coliform and BOD. These findings underscore the need for effective waste management and sewage treatment measures to mitigate the impact of large religious events on river water quality.

Water Quality Management Strategies

To ensure the safety and purity of water quality during the Maha Kumbh 2025, several strategies were implemented:

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The health monitoring system created a huge, useful database that will be of immense use for medical students in public health. The Ganga Mahasabha opined that the water quality was maintained during the Kumbh. However, some critics noted that the improvement was temporary and that the Ganga was likely to return to its normal level of pollution after the Mela.

Approaches to improve water quality:

The authorities of the UP government implemented several measures in November 2024 to combat water contamination, such as stopping industrial operations and preventing untreated sewage from entering the rivers. - 34 untapped sewers were diverted to temporary sewage treatment facilities (STPs).

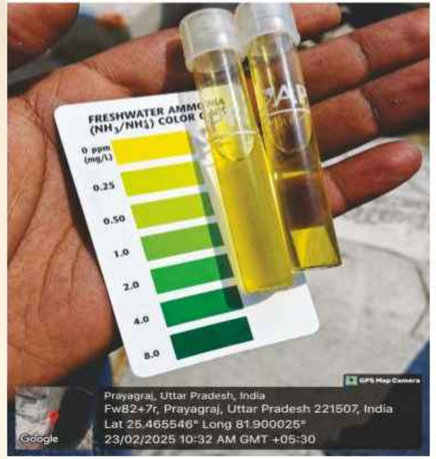
- 23 district industries were instructed to temporarily stop operations.
- As of January 7, the water quality was within safe bounds for bathing, according to UPPCB Chairperson Ravindra Pratap Singh.
- Furthermore, to dilute pollutants, more than 6,000 cusecs of fresh water were released into the Ganga from the Narora Dam in Bulandshahr. If more water was needed, officials said it would be released.

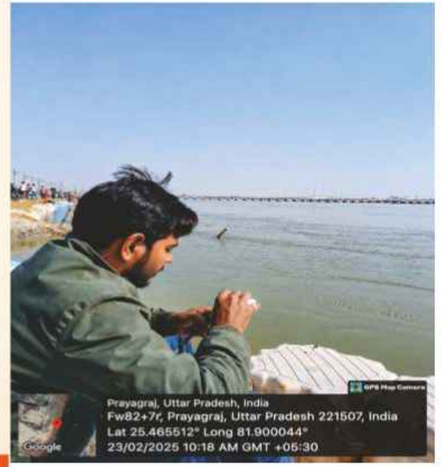
Trash Removal Efforts

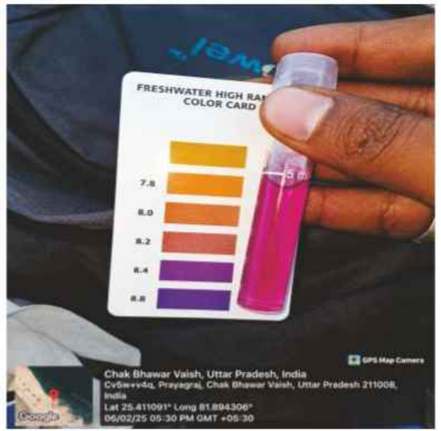
Trash skimmers were launched by the Prayagraj Municipal Corporation to remove floating trash from the Yamuna River and the Ganga River. To double the cleaning capacity, a second machine was purchased after the first one was utilised. 10-15 tonnes of garbage, including plastic, coconuts, floral offerings, and other items, were extracted daily with the help of these machines. The skimmers covered a 4-kilometre distance between the boat club and the Sangam.

Water Quality Monitoring

- To keep pollution levels under control, the Pollution Control Board tested samples from various ghats as part of its daily water quality monitoring program.
- To direct greywater to treatment facilities, authorities had also set up a temporary drainage system that spanned 200 km.
- A committed group of "Ganga Sevadoots" was posted at several ghats to further improve cleanliness by the government of UP.
- To keep the river clean, these volunteers worked in shifts that alternated, gathering and getting rid of ceremonial garbage every two hours.







Innovative Technologies

To efficiently manage greywater and human waste, authorities used technology from the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and the Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC). According to UP Chief Secretary Manoj Kumar Singh, all intercepted drains would undergo temporary treatment, and untreated sewage would not be permitted to enter the Ganga.

Conclusion

Research showed that the Sangam's PH ranged from 8.5 to 9 mg/l, and its ammonium content was between 0.5 and 1 mg/l, signifying a highly alkaline water condition with a potentially alarming ammonia content. Due to the increased toxicity of un-ionised ammonia, the Ganga River's fish and other aquatic life may be harmed by the combination of its high PH and moderate ammonium levels.

6.4 NO MISSING OUT ON ENVIRONMENTAL IMPERATIVE

Introduction

While the Maha Kumbh Melas hold immense spiritual and cultural significance, they also pose substantial environmental challenges, including pollution, waste accumulation, and ecosystem disruption. The 2025 Maha Kumbh presented a unique opportunity to implement sustainable event management strategies to mitigate these environmental impacts. This chapter examines the ecological consequences of the 2025 event, focusing on water and air pollution, waste management, and biodiversity conservation. It further evaluates the effectiveness of eco-friendly initiatives such as waste segregation, biodegradable materials, wastewater treatment, and sustainable infrastructure.

By analysing these measures, the chapter highlights best practices and policy recommendations for balancing religious traditions with environmental sustainability in large-scale gatherings. To handle communication, security, and logistics during the Maha Kumbh Mela 2025, a massive tele-communications infrastructure was required. The ecological management and environmental effects of radio-frequency radiation exposure resulting from elevated electromagnetic fields (EMF) during the event are the main topics of this study. Spectrum analysers, EMF meters, and dosimeters were used to measure the electric field strength, magnetic field strength, and power density throughout the pre-event, peak event, and post-event phases.

Environmental Impact of Maha Kumbh 2025

1. **Water Pollution:** The Ganges and other tributaries experience a surge in pollution due to mass bathing, ritual offerings, and waste disposal. The excessive human presence elevates bacterial contamination levels, impacting both aquatic life and human health. In Maha Kumbh 2025, authorities faced the challenge of maintaining water quality while accommodating millions of pilgrims.
2. **Solid Waste Management Challenges:** Waste generation during Maha Kumbh 2025 reached unprecedented levels, necessitating immediate interventions. The event saw an influx of plastic waste, discarded food, and ritualistic offerings, demanding efficient waste segregation and recycling mechanisms.
3. **Deforestation and Habitat Disruption:** Temporary settlements, roads, and event infrastructure led to encroachments on open lands and riverbanks. The displacement of flora and fauna was a key concern, requiring eco-sensitive planning.
4. **Air Pollution:** The increased movement of vehicles, the use of biomass for cooking, and temporary power generation units contributed to higher air pollution levels. Managing vehicular emissions and promoting sustainable transport options were crucial for minimising the environmental footprint.
5. **Sanitation and Public Health Concerns:** Inadequate sanitation infrastructure has historically been a challenge. The 2025 Maha Kumbh saw proactive measures such as the deployment of bio-toilets, but ensuring cleanliness remained a monumental task.

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Case Studies on Maha Kumbh 2025

Ecological Management

Case Study 1: Clean Ganga Initiative and Water Quality Monitoring

The Mahakumbh 2025 was a monumental event, attracting approximately 400 million devotees between January 13 and February 26, 2025. Ensuring the Ganga's water quality during such a massive gathering was paramount, intertwining with the objectives of the Namami Gange Programme. Water Quality Monitoring and Initiatives In the lead-up to Mahakumbh 2025, extensive measures were implemented to monitor and improve the Ganga's water quality:

- **Sewage Treatment:** The Prayagraj Municipal Corporation, in collaboration with Uttar Pradesh Jal Nigam, treated and released approximately 3,660 million liters per day (MLD) of water into the Ganga. Over 35 days, wastewater from 23 previously untreated drains was purified, ensuring cleaner river water for the pilgrims.
- **Geo-Tube Technology:** Innovative geo-tube technology was employed to filter and treat wastewater before its release into the river, enhancing the effectiveness of traditional sewage treatment methods.

Case Study 3: Green Transport and Carbon Footprint Reduction

To curb air pollution, the event introduced electric vehicles, bicycle-sharing programs, and pedestrian-friendly pathways. Public transportation services were optimised, reducing reliance on fossil fuels.

Case Study4 : Zero-Waste Management Strategy

For the first time in history, Maha Kumbh 2025 is embracing a groundbreaking zero-waste policy, setting a new benchmark for sustainable mega-events.

This sacred gathering, which attracts millions of devotees, is now committed to environmental responsibility through:

- Mandatory Waste Segregation – Specially designated bins across the venue ensure proper disposal of biodegradable, recyclable, and non-recyclable waste.
- Composting Units for Organic Waste – All biodegradable waste, including food scraps and flower offerings, will be processed into compost, minimizing landfill burden and enriching the soil.
- AI-Powered Waste Management – Cutting-edge artificial intelligence will monitor waste generation, optimize collection efficiency, and ensure real-time waste tracking to maintain cleanliness.
- Plastic-Free Environment – Strict regulations prohibit the use of plastic, encouraging eco-friendly alternatives such as cloth bags, biodegradable containers, and reusable utensils.

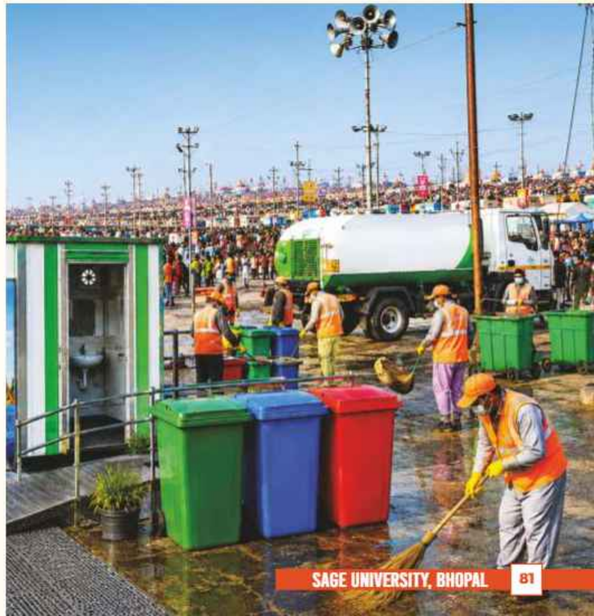
This bold initiative transforms Maha Kumbh 2025 into a spiritual and ecological marvel, preserving the sanctity of the event while paving the way for a cleaner, greener future.

Case Study 5:

An extensive network of bio-toilets and wastewater treatment plants ensured sustainable sanitation. Additionally, health camps provided free medical check-ups, preventing the spread of waterborne diseases.

Conclusion

Maha Kumbh 2025 set a precedent for sustainable religious gatherings through proactive environmental management. The implementation of green policies, advanced waste management, and water conservation strategies demonstrated that large-scale events can be managed sustainably without compromising cultural significance. By integrating modern technology with traditional wisdom, future Kumbh events can achieve a balance between devotion and ecological responsibility.



महाकुंभ के प्रमुख स्नान पर्व

पौष पूर्णिमा स्नान
पौष पूर्णिमा
(तारीख बदल सकती है)

मकर संक्रांति स्नान
14 जनवरी

मौनी अमावस्या
अमावस्या तिथि
(तारीख/परिवर्ती)

बसंत पंचमी
(तारीख/परिवर्ती)

माघी पूर्णिमा
पूर्णिमा तिथि

महाशिवरात्रि
(तारीख/परिवर्ती)

महाकुंभ: उत्सव और अनुभव

खंड 7:

7.1 महाकुंभ का पौराणिक और ऐतिहासिक महत्व

महाकुंभ मेले की जड़ें भारतीय पौराणिक कथाओं में गहराई से समाई हैं। समुद्र मंथन की कथा के अनुसार, देवताओं और असुरों ने अमृत कलश के लिए समुद्र मंथन किया था। इस प्रक्रिया में, अमृत की कुछ बूंदें पृथ्वी पर चार स्थानों प्रयागराज, हरिद्वार, उज्जैन, और नासिक पर गिरीं। इन्हीं स्थानों पर कुंभ मेले का आयोजन होता है। प्रयागराज में आयोजित महाकुंभ हर 144 वर्षों में एक बार होता है, जो इसे विशेष बनाता है।

महाकुंभ 2025 की विशेषताएँ:

- **अवधि:** 13 जनवरी से 26 फरवरी 2025 तक कुल 45 दिनों का आयोजन।
- **स्थान:** प्रयागराज में त्रिवेणी संगम, जहां गंगा, यमुना, और अदृश्य सरस्वती नदियों का संगम है।
- **श्रद्धालुओं की संख्या:** लगभग 56 करोड़ से अधिक लोगों की आज तक उपस्थिति और 45 दिन पूर्ण होने तक कुल लगभग 60 से 65 करोड़ लोगों की उपस्थिति इसे विश्व का सबसे बड़ा लोक समागम बन रहा है।

आधुनिक तकनीक और व्यवस्थाएँ:

महाकुंभ 2025 में, उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार ने व्यापक व्यवस्थाएँ कीं। लगभग 4000 हेक्टेयर क्षेत्र में एक अस्थायी शहर बसाया गया है, जिसमें लगभग 150,000 सरकारी और प्राइवेट टेंट लगाए गए हैं | समान संख्या में शौचालय जिसमें मोबाइल शौचालय भी शामिल हैं | 69,000 एलईडी और सोलर लाइट्स लगाई गई हैं, 15,000 से अधिक सफाई कर्मियों की तैनाती की गई है। सुरक्षा के लिए 50,000 से 70000 पुलिसकर्मी, सीसीटीवी कैमरे, ड्रोन, और अन्य तकनीकी साधनों का उपयोग किया गया।

महाकुंभ की वाहन व्यवस्था:

कुंभ मेले के दौरान भारी संख्या में श्रद्धालु पहुंचते हैं और इस तरह की भीड़ को नियंत्रित करने के लिए व्यापक वाहन व्यवस्था की आवश्यकता होती है जो प्रयागराज में की गई जिसमें साधारण लोगों के लिए और वी आई पी लोगों के लिए अलग-अलग की गई। निम्नलिखित आधारों पर महाकुंभ की वाहन व्यवस्था केंद्रित की गई:

1. **विशाल पार्किंग स्थलों का निर्माण:** मेले के दौरान हजारों वाहन (बस, कार, मोटरसाइकिल, ट्रक आदि) आते हैं, इसलिए विशेष पार्किंग स्थल बनाए गए हैं। यह पार्किंग स्थल मुख्य मेला क्षेत्र से दूर हैं, ताकि यातायात में कोई अवरोध न हो और लोग आसानी से अपने वाहनों को पार्क कर सकें लेकिन इसके कारण लोगों को कई किलोमीटर पैदल भी चलना पड़ रहा है। 144 साल वाला आया महाकुंभ 2025 का अनुभव मेरे लिए आध्यात्मिकता और रोमांच से भरपूर रहा। "शुरूवात से ही मन में उत्सुकता थी पर एक डर भी था कि इतनी भीड़ में सब कुछ संभव कैसे होगा। इस विशेष अवसर पर, भारतीय पर्यटन विकास निगम (आईटीडीसी) की एकमात्र महिला स्वतंत्र निदेशक होने के नाते, मुझे प्रयागराज में आयोजित महाकुंभ में शामिल होने का सौभाग्य प्राप्त हुआ।"

2. **सार्वजनिक परिवहन की व्यवस्था:** कुंभ मेला के दौरान प्रमुख स्थानों को जोड़ने के लिए विशेष बस सेवाएं शुरू की गई हैं। ये बसें विशेष रूप से श्रद्धालुओं के लिए निर्धारित की गई हैं और प्रशासन द्वारा चलाई जाने वाली ये बसें एक निश्चित समय सारणी के अनुसार चल रही हैं, मेला क्षेत्र तक आसानी से पहुँचाने का काम कर रही हैं पर कहीं न कहीं इतने श्रद्धालु पहुँच रहे हैं कि यह व्यवस्था कम पड़ रही है।

3. **ट्रैफिक पुलिस और मार्गदर्शन:** ट्रैफिक पुलिस की बड़ी तैनाती की गई है जो रास्तों को नियंत्रित कर रही है और यातायात की समस्या हल कर रही है, इसको हमने अपनी यात्रा के दौरान देखा भी अनुभव भी किया। विशेष मार्गों की पहचान कर दी गई थी और ज्यादा भीड़ वाली जगहों पर सुरक्षा के विशेष उपाय किए गए हैं। साथ ही, सार्वजनिक सूचना के लिए साइन बोर्ड और दिशा-निर्देश भी लगाए गए हैं। बहुत से बिजली के खंबो पर क्यू आरकोड लगाये गए हैं जिससे आपको पता चल सके की आप प्रयागराज के किस स्थान पर हैं|

4. **ऑनलाइन टिकट और वाहन पास:** श्रद्धालुओं के वाहन और बसों के लिए कई बार अग्रिम टिकट या पास की व्यवस्था की गई है। यह व्यवस्था लोगों को असुविधा से बचाने और यातायात को बेहतर तरीके से नियंत्रित करने के लिए की गई है। कुछ स्थानों पर वाहन पास प्राप्त करने के लिए ऑनलाइन पंजीकरण भी किया गया है। वाहनों को पास दिए गए हैं, इसकी खासियत ये थी कि पास कुछ दिनों के लिए ही दिए जा रहे हैं| एक दिन या दो दिन के लिए जिससे कोई इसका दुरुपयोग न कर पाए|

5. **डॉक्टर और इमरजेंसी सेवाएं:** महाकुंभ में सुरक्षा और स्वास्थ्य सुविधाएं भी एक महत्वपूर्ण हिस्सा रहती हैं। आपातकालीन चिकित्सा सेवा के लिए विभिन्न स्थानों पर एम्बुलेंस और मेडिकल कैंप लगाए गए हैं। इसके अलावा, दुर्घटनाओं से बचने के लिए वाहन चालकों को हेलमेट, सीट बेल्ट, और यातायात नियमों का पालन करने के लिए जागरूक किया गया है। अभी जब बड़े वाहन नहीं जा पा रहे वहां इन छोटी गाड़ियों का इस्तेमाल लोग अपने गंतव्य तक पहुंचने के लिए कर रहे हैं|

6. **ड्रोन से निगरानी:** मेला स्थल और यातायात की निगरानी के लिए ड्रोन का भी उपयोग किया जा रहा है। यह व्यवस्था प्रशासन को सटीक और तेज़ तरीके से सुरक्षा बनाए रखने में मदद कर रही है।

धार्मिक और सांस्कृतिक गतिविधियाँ:

मेले के दौरान, विभिन्न धार्मिक अनुष्ठान, प्रवचन, भागवत कथा, राम कथा, सांस्कृतिक कार्यक्रम अखाड़ों में किये जा रहे हैं। इस समय पूरे भारत के साधु संत, नागा साधु आये हुए हैं इनके आशीर्वाद लेना चाहते हैं। सबको जानकर ये आश्चर्य होगा कि ये नागा साधु सिर्फ आपको कुंभ या सिंहस्थ में दिखाई देते हैं फिर न जाने कहाँ चले जाते हैं। इससे अंदाजा लगाया जा सकता है कि वो कितने बड़े योगी हैं तो उनके दर्शन का लाभ हर कोई लेना चाहता है। शाही स्नान आयोजित किए गए और लगातार किए जा रहे हैं। अखाड़ों की पेशवाई, साधु-संतों के प्रवचन, और सांस्कृतिक प्रस्तुतियां मेले की शोभा बढ़ा रहे हैं। श्रद्धालु त्रिवेणी संगम में स्नान कर आध्यात्मिक शुद्धि प्राप्त कर रहे हैं।

प्रयागराज हवाई अड्डे का विस्तार:

प्रयागराज हवाई अड्डे ने महाकुंभ के लिए महत्वपूर्ण परिवर्तनों को अंजाम दिया है। यहां कनेक्टिविटी और फ्लाइट संचालन में इजाफा हुआ है, जिससे श्रद्धालुओं के लिए यात्रा अधिक सुविधाजनक हो गई है। जनवरी 2025 में लगभग 81 नई उड़ानें शुरू की गईं, और हवाई अड्डा अब 17 शहरों से सीधे जुड़ा हुआ है। अधिकारियों ने सुनिश्चित किया कि शाही स्नान जैसे विशेष अवसरों पर हवाई किराए किफायती रहें, ताकि श्रद्धालु आसानी से यात्रा कर सके | प्रयागराज की खासियत है कि वहां सैन्य हवाई अड्डा हो तो फोटो खींचना, मना है। इसके अलावा, यहां के बाथरूम भी बहुत विशेष हैं, जो किसी भी अन्य हवाई अड्डे से बड़े हैं।

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प्रयागराज टेंट सिटी

प्रयागराज में इस बार महाकुंभ की खासियत टेंट सिटी की रही। सरकारी और प्राइवेट टेंट पूरे आधुनिक संसाधनों से युक्त थे। बड़े सुन्दर रूप के आकार के, कुछ पारदर्शी टेंट जिससे उसमें बैठकर संगम के दर्शन हो सकें, खास रहे। हमारा सारा इंतजाम आईटीडीसी द्वारा किया गया था, जिसने मेला क्षेत्र में 100 आधुनिक टेंट स्थापित किए हैं। नदी किनारे स्थित इन टेंटों की सुंदर व्यवस्था सबका मन मोह रही है। टेंट में ठंड और मच्छरों से बचाव के सभी इंतजाम किये गए हैं, जिससे हमारा ठहराव भी आरामदायक रहा।

घाटों का इंतजाम

प्रयागराज हवाई अड्डे का विस्तार:

प्रयागराज हवाई अड्डे ने महाकुंभ के लिए महत्वपूर्ण परिवर्तनों को अंजाम दिया है। यहां कनेक्टिविटी और फ्लाइट संचालन में इजाफा हुआ है, जिससे श्रद्धालुओं के लिए यात्रा अधिक सुविधाजनक हो गई है। जनवरी 2025 में लगभग 81 नई उड़ानें शुरू की गईं, और हवाई अड्डा अब 17 शहरों से सीधे जुड़ा हुआ है। अधिकारियों ने सुनिश्चित किया कि शाही स्नान जैसे विशेष अवसरों पर हवाई किराए किफायती रहें, ताकि श्रद्धालु आसानी से यात्रा कर सके | प्रयागराज की खासियत है कि वहां सैन्य हवाई अड्डा हो तो फोटो खींचना, मना है। इसके अलावा, यहां के बाथरूम भी बहुत विशेष हैं, जो किसी भी अन्य हवाई अड्डे से बड़े हैं।

प्रयागराज टेंट सिटी

प्रयागराज में इस बार महाकुंभ की खासियत टेंट सिटी की रही। सरकारी और प्राइवेट टेंट पूरे आधुनिक संसाधनों से युक्त थे। बड़े सुन्दर रूप के आकार के, कुछ पारदर्शी टेंट जिससे उसमें बैठकर संगम के दर्शन हो सकें, खास रहे। हमारा सारा इंतजाम आईटीडीसी द्वारा किया गया था, जिसने मेला क्षेत्र में 100 आधुनिक टेंट स्थापित किए हैं। नदी किनारे स्थित इन टेंटों की सुंदर व्यवस्था सबका मन मोह रही है। टेंट में ठंड और मच्छरों से बचाव के सभी इंतजाम किये गए हैं, जिससे हमारा ठहराव भी आरामदायक रहा।

घाटों का इंतजाम

प्रयागराज में गंगा किनारे यमुना किनारे बड़े सुन्दर घाटों की आईटीबीपी द्वारा बनाए गए हैं। सुरक्षा की खास खातिर ये बोरों द्वारा गहराई कम की गई है। अच्छी लाइनें लगाई गई जिससे लोग गहराई में न जाये और डुबकी आसानी से लगाई जा सके। जेटी के पीछे हर थोड़ी दूरी पर नाव में गोताखोर बैठे हैं, सुना है एक दो छोटी मोटी घटना होने पर उन्होंने तत्परता से लोगों को डूबने से बचाया। हमारे साथ क्या हुआ इसका उल्लेख करना भी जरूरी है।

7.2 महाकुंभ: आस्था, सुविधाएँ और आध्यात्मिक ऊर्जा का महासंगम

भूमिका

महाकुंभ मेला, जिसे दुनिया का सबसे बड़ा धार्मिक आयोजन कहा जाता है, हर बार करोड़ों श्रद्धालुओं को अपनी आध्यात्मिक शक्ति से आकर्षित करता है। इस वर्ष के महाकुंभ में श्रद्धालुओं की आस्था और भक्ति की गहराई को करीब से समझने का अवसर मिला। महाकुंभ में गंगा के पवित्र जल में स्नान करने की अनुभूति शब्दों में बयान नहीं की जा सकती। जैसे ही जल में डुबकी लगाई जाती है, ऐसा प्रतीत होता है मानो वर्षों के सारे पाप धुल गए हों और मन को अद्भुत शांति प्राप्त हो रही हो।

महाकुंभ 2025 का आयोजन उत्तर प्रदेश के प्रयागराज में 13 जनवरी से 26 फरवरी 2025 तक हो रहा है। इस दौरान, करोड़ों श्रद्धालु त्रिवेणी संगम जहां गंगा, यमुना और पौराणिक सरस्वती नदियाँ मिलती हैं पर स्नान कर पुण्य लाभ प्राप्त करेंगे। उद्घाटन दिवस पर ही हर घंटे लगभग दो लाख से अधिक लोग संगम में स्नान कर रहे थे। महाकुंभ के सफल आयोजन के लिए प्रशासन ने व्यापक व्यवस्थाएँ की हैं। मेला क्षेत्र में अस्थायी नगर बसाए गए हैं, जहाँ श्रद्धालुओं के लिए शौचालय, पीने के पानी की आवश्यक सुविधाएँ उपलब्ध कराई गई हैं। इन सुविधाओं की ज़मीनी उपयोगिता जांचने के लिए तीन-तीन बार निरीक्षण किया जा रहा है।

भीड़ प्रबंधन के लिए प्रशासन ने विशेष यातायात और सुरक्षा प्रबंध किए हैं, ताकि श्रद्धालुओं को किसी प्रकार की असुविधा न हो। महाकुंभ के दौरान पुलिस और प्रशासन ने विशेष टीमें तैनात की हैं, जो पूरे क्षेत्र में शांति व सुविधा का संचालन देखती है। महाकुंभ के दौरान कुछ विशेष स्नान तिथियाँ निर्धारित की गई हैं, जिन्हें शाही स्नान कहा जाता है। इन तिथियों पर संगम में स्नान का विशेष महत्व है। मुख्य शाही स्नान तिथियाँ इस प्रकार हैं।

हालांकि, महाकुंभ में आने वाले श्रद्धालुओं को कुछ कठिनाइयों का भी सामना करना पड़ता है। भीड़ की अधिकता, ठहरने की दिक्कत और सफाई व्यवस्था में कुछ कमियाँ देखने को मिलती हैं। लेकिन सरकार और प्रशासन की ओर से व्यवस्थाएँ काफी हद तक संतोषजनक रही है। महाकुंभ केवल एक धार्मिक आयोजन नहीं, बल्कि आत्मशुद्धि और संस्कृति से जुड़ने का एक माध्यम है। जीवन में एक बार महाकुंभ का अनुभव अवश्य लेना चाहिए, यह आत्मा को एक नई ऊर्जा और शांति प्रदान करता है। इस प्रकार, महाकुंभ केवल एक धार्मिक समागम नहीं, बल्कि भारतीय संस्कृति की जीवंत झलक है, जो हर भक्त के हृदय को आध्यात्मिकता और आस्था से भर देती है।

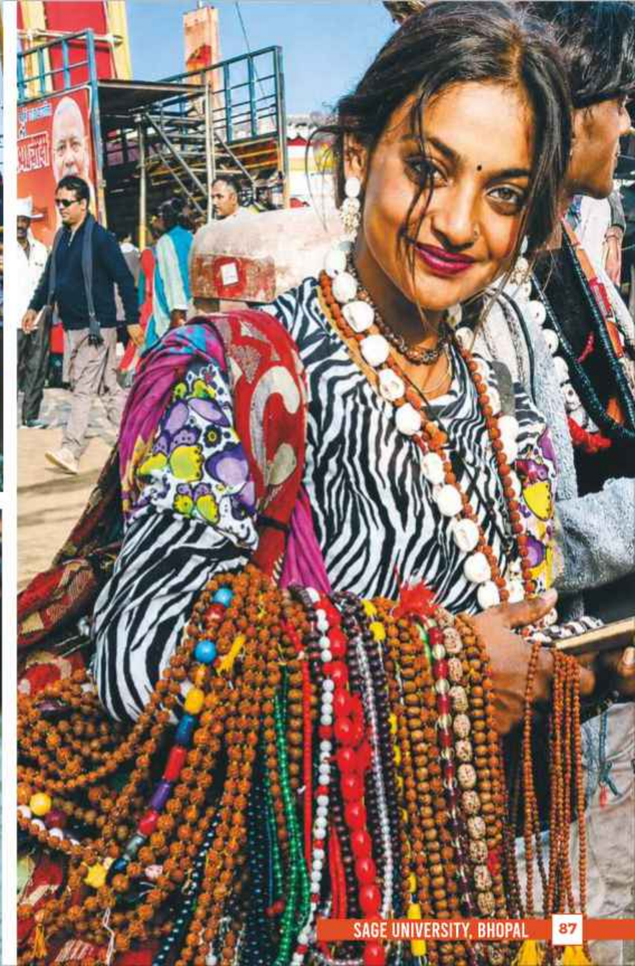
7.3 महाकुंभ 2025 – आस्था और आधुनिकता का संगम

भूमिका

महाकुंभ 2025, जो प्रयागराज में 13 जनवरी से 26 फरवरी तक आयोजित हुआ, इतिहास का सबसे बड़ा और भव्य कुंभ मेला साबित हुआ। इस कुंभ की विशेषताएँ भी बहुत है, यह सिर्फ एक धार्मिक आयोजन नहीं था, बल्कि यह आध्यात्मिकता, संस्कृति और आधुनिक ब्रांडिंग का संगम बन गया। जहाँ देश विदेश के लोग हिस्सा बने यहाँ तक बहुत अनोखे तरीके से इसे दर्शाया गया, जहाँ लोगों ने इसको एक पर्व के रूप में मनाया जो कि एक महीना चला।हमने देखा जहाँ एक ओर गंगा, यमुना और अदृश्य सरस्वती का संगम हुआ वो करोड़ों श्रद्धालुओं के लिए मोक्ष का द्वार बना, वहीं दूसरी ओर भारत और विश्वभर की कंपनियों के लिए यह एक विशाल ब्रांडिंग प्लेटफॉर्म भी साबित हुआ। ब्रांडिंग का रोल बहुत ही महत्वपूर्ण रहा जहाँ लोगों ने बहुत से विज्ञापन देखे, वीडियोज देखे जिनसे उन्हें कुंभ में उपस्थित होने पर मजबूर कर दिया। और तो इस बार ब्रांडों ने केवल विज्ञापन ही नहीं हुए बल्कि सामाजिक जागरूकता, पर्यावरणीय स्थिरता, डिजिटल इंडिया और लोकल इकोनॉमी को भी बढ़ावा दिया। जहाँ पर डिजिटल वर्ल्ड का नामोनिशान नहीं था, आज वहाँ हर व्यक्ति डिजिटल काम करते हुए दिखा चाहे वो पेमेंट करते हुए दिखा या कभी डायरेक्शन ढूँढते हुए, हमने देखा कि पूरा देश आज डिजिटल इनेबल्ड हो चुका है। इस अध्याय में हम महाकुंभ 2025 के दौरान अपनाई गई ब्रांडिंग रणनीतियों, डिजिटल अभियानों, स्थानीय अर्थव्यवस्था पर प्रभाव और इसके वैश्विक महत्व की विस्तार से चर्चा करेंगे।
वैश्विक महत्व की विस्तार से चर्चा करेंगे। और देखेंगे कि किसी कार्यक्रम और योजना को सफल बनाने में क्या क्या योगदान लगता है।

आयोजन की भव्यता

महाकुंभ 2025 अब तक का सबसे बड़ा कुंभ था। अनुमान के अनुसार, 50 करोड़ से अधिक श्रद्धालुओं ने इसमें भाग लिया। इसमें भारतीयों के साथ-साथ 100 से अधिक देशों से आए विदेशी पर्यटकों की भी भागीदारी रही। उन्होंने संस्कृति को जाना और पहचाना। सरकार ने इस आयोजन को ऐतिहासिक बनाने के लिए स्मार्ट सिटी सुविधाओं, डिजिटल पेमेंट सिस्टम, AI-आधारित भीड़ प्रबंधन और इको-फ्रेंडली इंफ्रास्ट्रक्चर पर विशेष ध्यान दिया। इस बार कुंभ मेला केवल एक धार्मिक उत्सव नहीं था, बल्कि भारत के तकनीकी, सांस्कृतिक और आर्थिक शक्ति प्रदर्शन का केंद्र बन गया। जहाँ विभिन्न प्रकार के डिजिटल योगदान भी देखने को मिले और तो कुंभ का ऐतिहासिक मंच आयोजित हुआ।



कुंभ में ब्रांडिंग क्यों महत्वपूर्ण है?

बड़ी संख्या में दर्शक – लाखों लोगों तक सीधा जुड़ने का अवसर मिला जैसे कि देखा गया कि बड़ी संख्या में लोगों का आगमन हुआ देश विदेश के पर्यटक आए और भव्य कुंभ में शामिल हुए जिससे उन्होंने भारत को और भी करीब से जाना यह तक की संस्कृति से अवगत भी हुए। ब्रांडिंग इसमें यह हुई कि पर्यटकों का सीधा संपर्क कुंभ देखने और वहां की सुख सुविधा का मिलना और डिजिटल योगदान देखा गया, चाहे बच्चे हो या बूढ़ा व्यक्ति सभी डिजिटल एक्टिव थे।भावनात्मक जुड़ाव – भारतीय संस्कृति और आस्था के प्रतीक के रूप में प्रचार हुआ, हम देखते है कैसे लोगो की आस्था और भावना जुड़ी हुई थी कुंभ से जो 144 साल बाद आया, भव्य कुंभ का आयोजन इसी प्रकार हुआ कि देखा गया कितने लोग शामिल हुए थे। जहाँ भारतीय संस्कृति से जुड़े सत्य, आस्था, विश्वास का प्रतीक बना। ब्रांडिंग भी उसी प्रकार से की गई जैसे इसे वीडियो बनाए गए जिससे लोगो का डायरेक्ट कनेक्ट हो और भावना को नुकसान न पहुंचे।स्थानीय और वैश्विक पहचान ब्रांडों के लिए अंतरराष्ट्रीय दर्शकों तक पहुँचने का जरिया मिला देखा गया कि कैसे महाकुंभ से ब्रांड पूरी देश और दुनिया में और सशक्त हो गया यही वजह है कि हर नामचीन कंपनी महाकुंभ में किसी न किसी रूप में खुद की ब्रांडिंग कर रही है। भारत और स्थानीय उत्पादों को बड़ा बाजार मिलने का मतलब मेक इन इंडिया, वोकल फॉर लोकल की ओर एक मजबूत कदम होगा। यह सरकार की सबसे सफल योजनाओं में से एक है। इस योजना के जरिए हर जिले के कुछ खास उत्पादों के देश और दुनिया में नई पहचान मिली है। जिस से ब्रांडिंग अंतरराष्ट्रीय लेवल पर हुई है। बताया गया कि कैसे देश की शीर्ष कंपनिया इस आयोजन के प्रचार प्रसार में करीब 30,000 करोड़ रूपए का निवेश कर रही

है। महाकुंभ में एक जिला एक उत्पाद (ODOP) की भव्य प्रदर्शनी लगाई गई है, जो 6,000 वर्ग मीटर क्षेत्र में फैली है इसमें उत्तर प्रदेश की सांस्कृतिक विरासत को दर्शाने वाली है।

डिजिटल और ऑन-ग्राउंड मार्केटिंग

ब्रांडों को नए और प्रभावी मार्केटिंग टूल्स अपनाने का मौका मिला सरकार ने डिजिटल तकनीक का सहारा लिया जो कि डिजिटल कुंभ पहल के तहत एक विशेष मोबाइल ऐप लॉन्च किया गया जो श्रद्धालुओं को शाही स्नान से लेकर यातायात और आवास तक की हर जानकारी प्रदान करेगा। ये ऐप कुंभ मेले में आने वाले लाखों भक्तों के लिए एक मार्गदर्शक की भूमिका निभा रहा है, इसकी मदद से महत्वपूर्ण स्थल के बारे में जान सकते है, बल्कि वे प्रयागराज के आसपास के पर्यटन स्थलों और धार्मिक स्थलों की जानकारी भी प्राप्त कर सकते हैं।ऐप की मुख्य विशेषताएंशाही स्नान की जानकारी: शाही स्नान की तिथियों से लेकर समय की जानकारी मिलेगी। यातायात और मार्ग: रेलवे स्टेशनों, बस स्टॉप और हवाई अड्डे की जानकारी प्रदान करता है। इसके अलावा पार्किंग स्थल की जानकारी भी ऐप पर उपलब्ध है। आवास और भोजन: ऐप में प्रयागराज में उपलब्ध विभिन्न प्रकार के आवास जैसे धर्मशाला, होटल और गेस्ट हाउस की जानकारी दी गई है। सुरक्षा और आपातकालीन सेवाएं: ऐप में आपातकालीन सेवाएं, जैसे पुलिस, अस्पताल और अग्निशमन सेवाओं के संपर्क नंबर दिए गए हैं।

कुंभ में ब्रांडिंग के प्रमुख तरीकेऑन-ग्राउंड एक्टिवेशनडाबर, पतंजलि, कोका-कोला और अमूल, पेटीएम जैसे बड़े ब्रांडों ने कुंभ मेला स्थल पर विशेष स्टॉल लगाए। डाबर ने हेल्थ चेकअप कैंप लगाए और श्रद्धालुओं को आयुर्वेदिक काढ़ा वितरित किया।

पेटीएम और गूगल पे ने कैशलेस ट्रांजेक्शन को बढ़ावा देने के लिए QR कोड आधारित भुगतान की सुविधा दी। जियो और एयरटेल ने 5G नेटवर्क लॉन्च कर हाई-स्पीड इंटरनेट की सुविधा उपलब्ध कराई।कोका कोला ने मैदान साफ कैम्पेन जारी करी ताकि एक स्थिरता और सामाजिक जिम्मेदारी को पूरा किया।

डिजिटल और सोशल मीडिया कैंपेन

"हर हर कुंभ, डिजिटल कुंभ" थीम के तहत डिजिटल मीडिया पर ब्रांड्स ने बड़े स्तर पर प्रचार किया। छोटा ब्रांड हो या बड़ा हर तरह की ब्रांडिंग बहुत जोरो शोरों से हुई। #Kumbh2025, #DigitalKumbh, और #CleanKumbh जैसे हैशटैग वायरल हुए। यूट्यूब, फेसबुक और इंस्टाग्राम पर लाखों लोगों ने कुंभ लाइव स्ट्रीमिंग देखी। जहाँ भव्य स्नान की बात हो या आरती की सभी श्रद्धालुओं के जो नहीं आ पाए उनके लिए ऑनलाइन व्यवस्था करी गई।

पर्यावरण और स्वच्छता अभियानों में ब्रांडों की भागीदारी

डिजिटल इंडिया ने "स्वच्छ कुंभ, स्वस्थ कुंभ" अभियान चलाया और मेला क्षेत्र में सैनिटेशन टॉयलेट्स और हैंड वॉश स्टेशन लगाए। महाकुंभ 2025 को स्वच्छ और पर्यावरण के अनुकूल बनाने की दिशा में प्रयागराज नगर निगम द्वारा पूरी प्रतिबद्धता के साथ कदम बढ़ाए जा रहे हैं।

महाकुंभ के दौरान स्वच्छ कुंभ कोष के तहत सभी सफाई कर्मियों को आयुष्मान भारत योजना के तहत पंजीकृत किया जाएगा और जीवन बीमा पॉलिसीज की व्यवस्था भी की जाएगी।

निष्कर्ष: कुंभ 2025 – आस्था और आधुनिकता का संगम

महाकुंभ 2025 ने यह साबित कर दिया कि यह केवल एक धार्मिक आयोजन नहीं, बल्कि ब्रांडिंग, टेक्नोलॉजी, और आर्थिक विकास का एक

प्रमुख मंच है। जहाँ श्रद्धालु आध्यात्मिक शांति की खोज में आए, वहीं ब्रांडों ने उन्हें सुविधाएँ देकर अपना स्थायी प्रभाव छोड़ा। डिजिटल मीडिया, स्मार्ट टेक्नोलॉजी, AI, पर्यावरणीय पहल और स्थानीय अर्थव्यवस्था को बढ़ावा देने जैसी रणनीतियाँ कुंभ 2025 को भविष्य के आयोजनों के लिए एक आदर्श मॉडल बनाती हैं।महाकुंभ अब सिर्फ एक मेला नहीं, बल्कि एक ब्रांड बन चुका है और यह ब्रांड हर बार नया इतिहास लिखता है। भीड़ के बीच अलग दिखने के लिए कई ब्रांड साथ जुड़े जिसमें उन्होंने कई कैंपेनिंग भी शुरू करी जो कि बहुत प्रभावशाली रही और लोगों को मार्गदर्शन भी किया।

Introduction

The Mahakumbh Mela, one of the largest human gatherings on the Planet, consistently produces jaw-dropping figures. Here's a look at some staggering figures from past and anticipated Mahakumbh events, particularly in Prayagraj, where it's held every 12 years. The festival spanned 45 days (13 Jan – 26 Feb 2025) at Prayagraj. A whopping 660 million (66 crore) devotees took the sacred dip by the conclusion, coming from over 120 countries, making it officially the world's largest gathering ever witnessed. At peak, the daily holy dip count peaked astonishingly high:

- Mauni Amavasya (29 Jan) drew 7.64 crore pilgrims.
- Makar Sankranti (14 Jan) saw around 4 crore devotees bathing in a single day.
- On Mahashivratri (26 Feb), over 41 lakh by 6 am, rising to 81 lakh by 10 am.
- Daily footfall averaged around 50–70 lakh (5–7 million) regular participants.

1. Water & Sanitation

- Sewage-to-Treatment Plants (STPs) – capacity 340 MLD; real-time IoT sensors verify <10 mg/L BOD at discharge.
- Bio-toilets & eco-urinals – 75,000 units, reducing open defecation hotspots by 93 % vs 2019 baseline.
- River remediation pilots – floating wetlands and enzymatic dosing delivered a 22 % drop in faecal coliform levels during peak weeks.

2. Zero-Waste & Circular Economy

- Three-bin segregation at 7,400 pilgrim camps; >78 % waste diverted to composting/ recycling.
- In-vessel composters processed 1,200 t/day of food waste into saleable organic fertiliser.
- Plastic-free zones enforced via RFID-tagged vendor permits; 3 MT of single-use plastic avoided.
- Cleaning Workforce: 20,000+ safai karmacharis working in 3 shifts, as 3,000 tons of waste are generated daily.

3. Environmental and Energy

- Solar micro-grids (7 MWp) powered LED lighting corridors, saving ~8,200 MWh grid electricity.
- EV & CNG shuttle fleet (1,100 vehicles) cut tail-pipe $PM_{2.5}$ by 17 $\mu g/m^3$ relative to 2019.
- Diesel generator phase-out achieved 92 % substitution with

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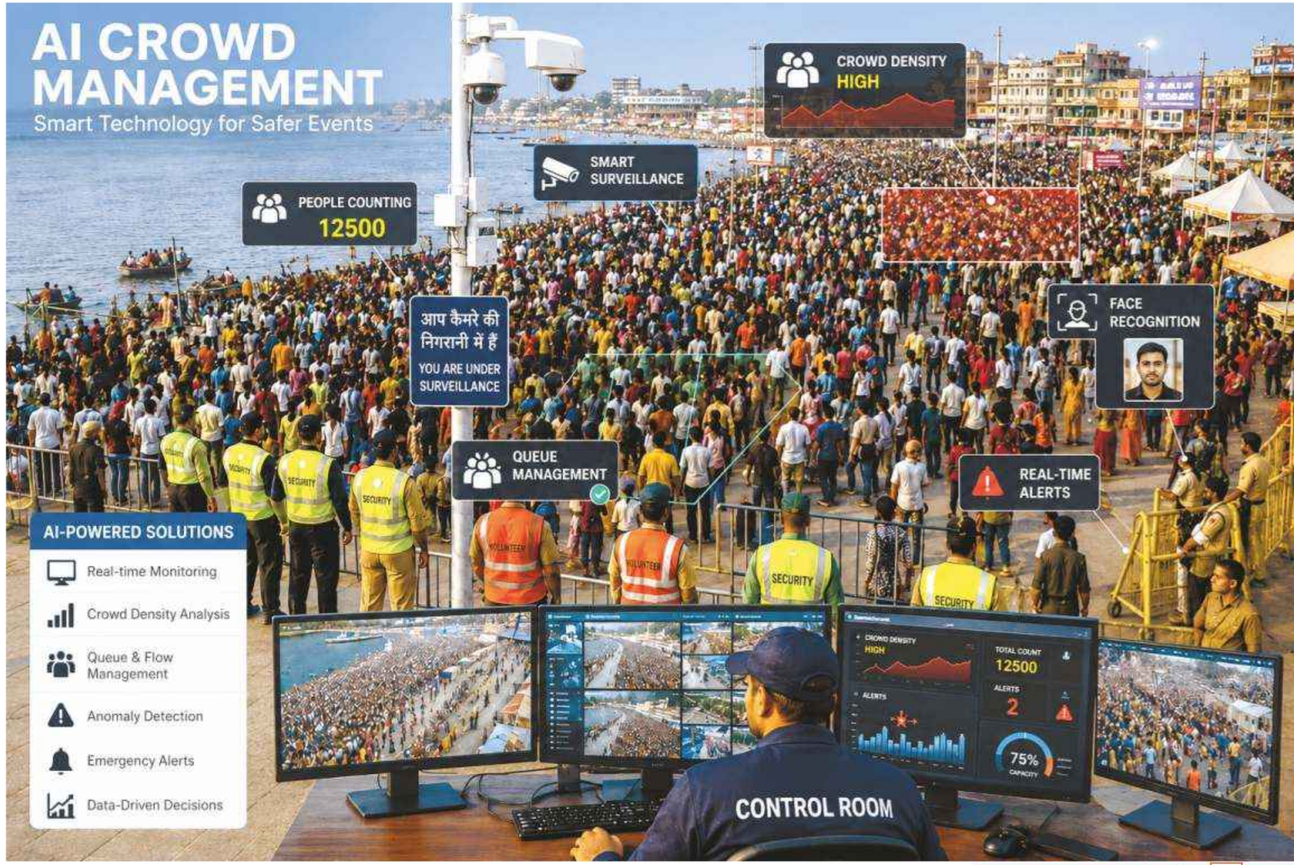

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Metric	Maha Kumbh 2025	Ardh Kumbh 2019
Budget (government (provisional)	₹ 5,800 cr	₹ 4,200 cr spending) (actual)
Pilgrim/visitor count	~200 million	~150 million
Cost per pilgrim	**₹ 29**	**₹ 28**

[illegible] defecation hotspots by 93 % vs 2019 baseline.

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Metric	Value (2025 cluster)	Source
Units deployed	50000	UP-PWD report
Avg. daily uses/unit	225	Sensor log extract
Biogas yielded	3400 m^3 day^{-1}	Vendor dashboard
Street-lights powered	1100	NTPC CSR note
Uptime (QR scan	96 %	Real-time ops feed

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Ms. Sakshi Thareja, Assistant Professor, School of Architecture, Planning and Design

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Mr. Aayush Raghuvanshi, Mr. Mayank Shrivastava, Mr. Utkarsh Verma & Mr. Shrey Gupta, BBA Students, School of Management

Section 3: ***Kumbh as Business Manager***

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5.2 Engineering Excellence Ensures Seamless Facilities

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Dr. Mukesh Dixit, Professor, School of Engineering Technology

5.3 AI & Data Science Guarantee Devotee Safety

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Dr. Kirti Jain, Professor, School of Computer Technology

Dr. Megha Vashishtha, Assistant Professor, School of Computer Technology

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6.2 Be Sure, Your Health's In Safe Hands

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6.3 Safe Drinking Water Set As Top Priority

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Ms. Somashree Bhakta, Research Scholar, School of Agriculture

Mr. Yogesh Sachan, Research Scholar, School of Agriculture

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Dr. Priyanka Gupta, Associate Professor, School of Sciences

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